

How to Like People

A book about dogs, monkeys, and meeting ten thousand people.

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Contents

Introduction

Chapter 1: It Starts With a Smile

Chapter 2: Overcoming Social Anxiety

Part I: Verbal Communication

Chapter 3: Verbal Communication

Chapter 4: The Power of Verbal Communication and Words

Chapter 5: The Second of the “3 Things” Gratitude

Part II: Nonverbal Communication

Chapter 6: The Science of Nonverbal Communication

Chapter 7: The Practice of Nonverbal Communication

Chapter 8: Reframing

Chapter 9: Communication Enhancements

Part III: Meeting Individuals

Chapter 10: Review and Putting It All Together

Chapter 11: Who Are All These People?

Chapter 12: Meet People

Chapter 13: Get Out and Meet People

Chapter 14: The Physical Not the Psychological

Part IV: Groups

Chapter 15: Meeting Groups of People

Chapter 16: Keep Meeting People

INTRODUCTION

The three scenarios

This book is your guide to shaping how others perceive you, turning every encounter – a meeting, a negotiation, a chance introduction – into an opportunity for a meaningful connection. This will result in making everyone you meet, everyone you interact with, and everyone you know, into someone who enjoys interacting with you and who seeks your company, supports your business, or simply wants to be friends. Whatever the case may be, we can clarify this using three illustrative scenarios: Picture this: You're about to meet someone new. Beforehand, mutual friends have filled both of you with anticipation, sharing praises and creating a sense of excitement about the connection to be made. This setup, where both parties are eager and have positive preconceptions, sets the stage for a fruitful interaction. Now, imagine a situation where you're advised to introduce yourself to a stranger, without any mutual connections or prior endorsements. This scenario, devoid of pre-established expectations, presents a blank canvas on which your interaction will paint its first strokes. Finally, consider the challenge of approaching someone who has been misinformed about you, harboring negative expectations, just as you've been led to believe less-than-flattering things about them. This scenario is fraught with barriers from the onset. Our aim is to navigate you towards consistently achieving the warmth and positivity of the first scenario, even under the conditions of the latter two. For those who might find the idea of such introductions daunting or anxiety-inducing, this book is a beacon, guiding you to a place where every new person feels like an old friend, where genuine connections are forged with ease. Through a blend of strategic communication techniques grounded in scientific research, and a focus on empathy and personal growth, we'll equip you with the tools to not only make a great first impression but also to deepen these encounters into rewarding relationships. This approach ensures that whether your aspirations are rooted in professional success or personal enrichment, your interactions will be authentic, engaging, and warmly received.

Understanding the value of human interaction

True connection hinges on recognizing that every interaction is an exchange of value. People often don't understand this principle, leading to conversations that falter because the value received doesn't justify the effort. Imagine the futility of exchanging identical currency — spending energy without gaining anything in return. Whether you seek to build deeper connections or excel in professional settings, this book will empower you to ensure each encounter is mutually beneficial. You'll learn to create interactions where the value gained

by both parties consistently exceeds the energy expended. Think about the people in your life who consistently leave you feeling drained or uninspired after a conversation. Perhaps they only complain, focus on the negative, or solely talk about themselves. This imbalance of value is what we want to avoid – because ultimately, it discourages future interactions. True connection thrives on mutual uplift and a feeling that both parties left the interaction enriched. Understanding that conversations are an exchange of value doesn't negate the importance of genuine connection, empathy, and warmth. In fact, by being mindful of the value we bring and the value we receive, we can create interactions that are even more meaningful and emotionally fulfilling for everyone involved. This book empowers you to make those small yet impactful adjustments to your communication, both verbal and nonverbal. You'll discover techniques that naturally draw people into the conversation, making them feel valued and eager to continue interacting with you. With practice, these methods will transform how you connect with others, ensuring every exchange leaves both parties feeling enriched.

Communication is what the listener does

True communication isn't just the words you choose. It's what the listener actually takes away.

Every person filters your message through their dominant sense and through their own history and knowledge. Miss those filters and the same sentence can land as noise, offense, or nothing at all.

Sensory filters

Some people are Visual — they think in pictures.

Some are Auditory — they think in sound.

Some are Kinesthetic — they think in physical sensation and feeling.

The same afternoon on a lake becomes three different experiences:

Visual: “The lake was a brilliant mirror reflecting the azure sky. The sun glistened off the ripples, creating sparkling diamonds on the water. Tall pines lined the shore against the deep blue.”

Auditory: “The gentle lap of water against the boat was rhythmic. Birds sang from the pines while the soft rustle of needles carried on the wind. Distant laughter completed the soundtrack.”

Kinesthetic: “The boat swayed with the lake’s rhythm. Sun warmed my skin, broken by the occasional cool splash. The scent of pine filled the air and grounded every moment.”

Experience filter

The same words also hit differently depending on what the other person already knows and has lived. A casual mention of nuclear physics engages a scientist and loses almost everyone else. A joke that is harmless to one person can sting another because of their personal history.

You cannot control their filters. You can only become aware of them. That awareness is the starting point for everything that follows in this book.

What this book will teach you

This book will teach you several practical communications skills as well as some of the science behind those skills.

First, how to control your nonverbal communication - the 80% that people actually notice. You will learn to manage your facial expressions, posture, presence and the small signals that make others feel comfortable or guarded around you.

Second, how to use your limited verbal time for high-value conversation. You will learn how to start interactions that get the other person engaged, talking, and interested in continuing. The goal is not to dominate the conversation, the goal is to create the conditions where the other person wants to talk with you and walks away feeling the exchange was valuable. Your verbal and nonverbal communication work together. Better body language opens the door. Better verbal communication keeps the conversation alive and makes the other person glad they met you. The rest of this book is the training for these.

How the book is organized / Who it’s for

This book is written for people who want better results from their interactions—stronger personal and professional relationships, more tips, more sales, more dates, and less friction when meeting people or having small talk. It is especially useful if you have ever felt that “soft skills” advice was too vague, too gentle, or disconnected from real outcomes.

If you already consider yourself socially skilled or an extrovert, the material will sharpen specific tools: framing, nonverbal control, and conversation structure. If you already consider yourself socially skilled or an extrovert, the material will sharpen specific tools: framing, nonverbal control, and conversation structure. If social interactions currently feel effortful or anxiety-producing, this book is not asking you to walk out today and smash through a brick wall like the Kool-Aid Man just to hang out with a group of people. The early chapters give you concrete, low-risk practice so you can build skills gradually, without needing to become someone else overnight or force yourself into high-pressure situations before you are ready.

The methods are practical, and the theory only appears when it improves the execution. The aim is consistent, usable skills which become natural habits, not some inspiration or motivational talk or X number of things to say.

CHAPTER 1

It Starts With a Smile

“I love smiling; smiling’s my favorite” ~Buddy the Elf in Elf.

Who doesn’t like smiling? Do you like smiling? Do you enjoy being happy? Like your future interactions with others, your journey begins and ends with a smile. Smiling, along with slightly raising your eyebrows, has historic precedence. A long time ago, there were knights in shining armor – actual knights in sometimes-shining armor. Knights would raise their face shields when meeting someone, a show of vulnerability and a way to reduce the perceived threat. Yes, the perceived threat humans pose to one another. Similar to why we shake hands with our right hand. Shaking hands with your right hand or approaching someone with your right hand extended shows you are not carrying a weapon. You are not about to attack. More recently gentlemen would tip their hats. Similar rituals have existed for as long as humans have roamed the earth, and they differ by culture and need. While we no longer wear armor, the principles of non-threatening communication still apply. Today, a simple smile is your most powerful tool. A complicated art and science exist when correctly forming your face for an introduction or greeting. All of these are far beyond the scope of this book. Instead of studying the anatomy of the facial muscles and the brain’s neuroscience, you will learn how to smile naturally. Why are you reading about smiling on your journey to becoming an effective and positive communicator or an extrovert? How many sad frowning extroverts do you know? One of the essential things to do when communicating and meeting people is to ensure they want to communicate with you. Smiling helps, especially if it’s the first thing another person experiences from you. Even more impressive if it’s a genuine smile brought on by happiness. At the end of this chapter and with some intentional practice, you will begin to hear others’ feedback. Questions and comments such as “Why are you so happy?” “You have a fantastic smile.” “I remember your smile.” Among others, it will begin to become common all through the simple act of changing from the common fake courtesy smile to a genuine, heartfelt smile. Those who are unused to being complimented or asked about their happiness may find it challenging to respond to these inquiries. Simply smiling and saying, “thank you,” is perfectly acceptable. And the best part? Practicing genuine smiles will actually make you feel happier! The fundamental thing to know is this; if you want great ABs, you need to do some crunches. Suppose you want to be great at anything, you need to practice. When you attempt to become great at something or achieve success, you must also

embrace, if not, strive for failure. We'll dig deeper into failure later. For now, to put it simply, if you want to be great at smiling, you need to do some smiles. This practice is essential for becoming a positive communicator and extrovert.

Workout Your Smile Muscles

I want you to smile. Right now. Start smiling. Now, whatever you are doing, overdo it. Smile harder, smile more. This will feel odd, forced, weird – that's the point! Keep smiling and make an over-smiley face! You're not trying for a genuine smile, but deliberately exaggerating to stretch those smile muscles. Think this feels silly? Worried people will think you're strange? Trust me, the benefits far outweigh any initial awkwardness. Remember, no one can see you practicing in private! Plus, the more you do this, the more natural it will feel.

Coaching Session: Exercising your smile muscles

Make a significantly exaggerated smile, smile as big as you can.

You might need to pull your smile into place with your fingers, smile big!

Hold your smile and slowly open your mouth as wide as you can.

Hold your smile, and slowly close your mouth until your teeth touch.

Repeat this a few times.

And then stop smiling

Practice this daily and prior to being around groups of people.

End of Session

If you try this exercise in front of a mirror, you'll notice that after stretching, your smile will come easier and appear more natural. Before any interaction, big or small, take a moment to warm up those smile muscles. Think of it like stretching before a workout – essential for optimal performance. If you're not someone who smiles frequently, practicing daily is crucial. Always warm up your smile before social events, meetings, presentations, or any time you'll be interacting with others. While these exercises will improve your smile, there's more to it than just muscle movement. The vast majority of smiles in the world lack a key ingredient... genuine emotion. As you'll learn later, people subconsciously pick up on these subtle differences. I want you to be the type of person whose smile radiates genuine happiness. A smile so warm and welcoming that it leaves a lasting impression. With consistent practice, this will become your signature.

Let's Smile Genuinely on Command! The science on whether fake smiles can boost happiness seems divided. Some studies suggest it works, while others find no significant effect. Instead of relying on inconclusive research, let's find a more reliable method. Even when perfectly executed, fake smiles lack the subtle cues that convey genuine happiness. Studies involving electrical stimulation of facial muscles prove this. There are tiny differences in how the muscles around your eyes and mouth move that make all the difference. So, simply mimicking the physical act of smiling won't cut it. To achieve a truly genuine smile, we need to go directly to the source – your brain. Our brains take shortcuts when processing the vast amount of information they receive. You've seen examples of this with optical illusions and magic tricks. Soon, you'll learn how to harness these shortcuts for powerful results, starting with transforming your smile. Think back to the famous scientist Ivan Pavlov and his Nobel Prize-winning work with dogs. If you're not familiar, he discovered that by ringing a bell before feeding them, the dogs eventually started salivating at the sound of the bell, even without food being present. This is called classical conditioning – a brain shortcut that exists in humans too!

Ring goes the bell; drool goes the dog.

SmileBells™: Your Secret Weapon for Genuine Smiles

Forget faking it or resorting to electrical shocks. With Classical Conditioning, your happiness will be genuine and contagious! Your brain can learn to associate a stimulus (like a touch) with a response (a genuine smile). This is your SmileBell™ – a simple way to trigger happiness on demand. We can use any of the five senses, but touch is the easiest to use discreetly in public.

Creating Your SmileBell™

Choose Your Spot: Pick a place on your body that's easy to reach subtly. We recommend a two-finger press just below your collarbone for maximum discretion.

Ring Your Bell: This is your chosen touch action to activate your SmileBell™. **Link to Happiness:** Close your eyes in a quiet place and conjure up a recent memory of when you were genuinely happy and laughing. Vividly relive that moment using all your senses. When you reach that peak feeling of joy, ring your SmileBell™ to cement the association. Just Like Pavlov's Dogs... Remember, it takes repetition for conditioning to take hold! After creating your SmileBell™, you need to return to a neutral emotional state. How long this takes will vary for each person. Then, repeat the cycle: happiness, ring your SmileBell™, back to

neutral. Aim for at least 21 repetitions within a week. Reinforce and Maintain: Strengthen the connection every time you feel genuine happiness – watching a funny movie, hearing a great joke, etc. Remember, consistency is key! Keep using the same location and touch action.

The Power of Your SmileBell™

While your SmileBell™ won't make you permanently blissful, it will give you a happiness boost linked to the strength of your initial conditioning. Repetition matters! Use it during conversations for an extra dose of positivity. Over time, you may need to reinforce the conditioning, but you'll always have this powerful tool at your fingertips. Need Extra Help? If you're struggling with this concept, a personal coach can assist. Remember, genuine smiling is crucial for the positive human interactions this book teaches.

Coaching Session 2A: Setting Your CalmBell™

Setting Your CalmBell™

Find Your Zen: Choose a comfortable seated position with your feet flat on the floor.

Breathe Deeply: Close your eyes (if you're not reading) and focus on your breath. Inhale slowly through your nose, and exhale gently through your mouth.

Tune In: Notice the rise and fall of your chest with each breath.

Multi-Sensory Calmness: Touch: Using your non-dominant hand, press gently with two fingers just under the collarbone on the opposite side of your body. Hold for a few seconds.

Sight: Observe your hand moving to and touching this spot.

Sound: As you touch, whisper or softly say the word "calm." Release and Repeat: Release your touch and return to focusing on your breath. Repeat steps 3-4 several times.

Tips for Deeper Relaxation: Soothing Sounds: If you need help reaching a calm state, try playing gentle music or nature sounds in the background.

Tension & Release: From head to toe, tense each muscle group for five seconds, then release. This can further deepen relaxation.

Remember, the calmer you are during this process, the stronger your CalmBell™ will be. Practice this daily for a week to solidify your CalmBell™.

Coaching Session 2B: Setting Your SmileBell™

Building on Your Calm: Stay in your comfortable seated position and maintain the sense of calmness you've established.

Tap into Joyful Memories: Find Your Happy Place: Think back to a recent memory that

brought genuine laughter and a big smile.

Immerse Yourself: Relive the moment vividly.

Sights: Recall the details, colors, and people involved.

Sounds: Hear the laughter, conversations, or music.

Sensations: Remember the feeling of your surroundings.

Tastes & Smells: If applicable, bring to mind any tastes or scents associated with the experience.

Seal the Happiness with Multi-Sensory Reinforcement: Touch: When you feel a genuine smile spread across your face (or even a chuckle escapes), set your SmileBell™. Reach up with your dominant hand and gently press two fingers just under your collarbone on the same side of your body. Hold for one breath or until your laughter subsides. Sight: Observe your hand moving to and touching this spot.

Sound: As you touch, say or whisper the word "happy" or "joy" (choose what feels most natural). Release and Repeat: Release your touch and return to a neutral, calm state. Repeat this process at least 21 times, ideally over several days. Using different joyful memories can strengthen the conditioning. Important Notes: Time & Patience: Take your time with each repetition – don't rush! Leave 10-15 minute breaks between sets.

Consistency is Key: Practice setting your SmileBell™ at least 21 times to solidify the connection.

Coaching Session 2C: Testing Your Bells

It's time to see if your SmileBell™ and CalmBell™ are working! Remember, this is about conditioning your brain – not magic. So, it's important to follow these guidelines, especially in the beginning: Prep for Success: Neutral State: Start from a calm, neutral emotional place. If you're feeling stressed or upset, wait until you feel more balanced.

Breathe Deeply: Take five slow, deep breaths. Inhale through your nose, hold briefly, and exhale through your mouth, focusing on the sensation of your breath.

Testing Your Bells: CalmBell™ Test: Visualization: Imagine the relaxed state you were in when setting your CalmBell™.

Multi-Sensory Activation: Touch: Gently touch your CalmBell™ spot (non-dominant hand, under opposite collarbone).

Sight: Observe your hand movement.

Sound: Whisper or say "calm" as you touch.

Breathe & Observe: Release, take five deep breaths, and notice any subtle shifts toward calmness within you.

SmileBell™ Test: Happy Visualization: Recall one of the joyful memories used to set your SmileBell™.

Multi-Sensory Activation: Touch: Activate your SmileBell™ (dominant hand, under same-side collarbone).

Sight: Observe your hand movement.

Sound: Say "happy", "joy", or a similar word as you touch.

Breathe & Feel: Release, take five deep breaths, or wait until your laughter subsides. Observe whether a genuine smile lingers and feelings of happiness remain.

Important Notes: Patience & Practice: It takes repetition for conditioning to take hold. Don't get discouraged if the results are subtle at first.

Start Small: Use your Bells in controlled environments before relying on them in high-stress situations.

Building on Success: Remember, like with Pavlov's dogs, results may not be immediate. Brains are unique, and it takes repetition for conditioning to become strong. Don't get discouraged if your Bells don't have an instant effect. Keep practicing, and as Winston Churchill said, "Success is not final, failure is not fatal: it is the courage to continue that counts." Understanding the Effects: Temporary Boost: Your Bells provide an emotional boost, not permanent happiness or calmness. Think of it as a nudge in the desired direction.

Repetition Matters: The more you set and reinforce your Bells, the stronger and longer-lasting the effect will be.

The emotional boost from your Bells can help build confidence and make social interactions feel more comfortable.

The more you practice, the greater your ability to influence your emotional state will become.

Maximizing Results: Visualization: Before activating a Bell, imagine the desired feeling. This enhances the power of conditioning.

Repeated Activation: Activate your Bells multiple times to intensify the feeling for that moment.

Pressure Variation (Optional): Experiment with slightly firmer pressure when activating your Bells (avoiding causing any discomfort). This may evoke a stronger emotional response.

Maintaining Your Bells: Just like any skill, if you don't use your Bells, the conditioning will gradually fade. Regular reinforcement is key – especially in the beginning. Here's how: SmileBell™: Reactivate it during genuinely happy moments, like watching a funny movie or hearing a good joke.

CalmBell™: Reactivate it whenever you feel a sense of peace or deep relaxation.

Coaching Session 2D: Reinforcing Your Bells

Strengthening your Bells is essential for long-lasting results. Here's how: Reinforce Your SmileBell™: During Genuine Joy: Reactivate it whenever you're laughing or feeling genuinely happy – a hilarious scene in a movie, a friend's witty joke, a well-deserved accomplishment, or exciting news.

The Power of Frequent Reinforcement: The more often you reinforce your SmileBell™ with positive experiences, the stronger and more automatic it will become!

Reinforce Your CalmBell™: Seek Natural Relaxation: After stretching, meditation, enjoying a calming book or movie, petting your animal companion – any time you feel relaxed and at peace.

Essential Notes on Timing: Avoid Artificial Calmness: Do NOT reinforce your CalmBell™ when feeling tired, sleepy, or under the influence of medications or drugs. You want to link it to a true sense of inner peace.

CHAPTER 2

Overcoming Social Anxiety

Impossible! What do Buddhist monks, pathological liars, and hypnotists have in common with extroverts, happy people, the wealthy and uber successful? They each understand the plasticity of reality – the idea that our perception of the world is created by our minds, not solely by external events. This understanding unlocks the potential to reshape our experiences, including how we connect with others. Remember the three scenarios from earlier? This book is your guide to consistently achieving that positive first-encounter feeling, regardless of the person or situation. If doubts about achieving meaningful connections have ever crossed your mind, you most certainly can. Lewis Carroll, Arthur C Clarke, Elon Musk, Alexander Graham Bell and thousands of others have advice for you. Here are three selected pieces of advice:

Alice "There's no use trying; one can't believe impossible things." The Queen: "I daresay you haven't had much practice. When I was younger, I always did it for half an hour a day. Why sometimes I've believed as many as six impossible things before breakfast." ~Alice In Wonderland by Lewis Carroll

Clarke's Second Law: The only way of discovering the limits of the possible is to venture a little way past them into the impossible. ~ Arthur C. Clarke "Hazards of Prophecy: The Failure of Imagination" Profiles of the Future 1962

Elon Musk could not build a reusable rocket to fly to the ISS and, eventually, Mars. It was impossible. Even more, Elon didn't know anything about rockets! Yet in 2020, a reusable rocket flew Bob and Doug to the ISS. Elon believed the impossible. So can you. These three examples highlight the power of believing in possibilities beyond what seems logical or achievable. Alice's journey shows us that with practice, you can expand your imagination and belief in what's possible. Arthur C. Clarke reminds us that true breakthroughs happen when you push past perceived limits. And Elon Musk demonstrates that unwavering belief, combined with action, can turn the 'impossible' into reality. This same mindset is key to transforming your own communication and achieving extraordinary results.

Overcoming Social Anxiety

Whether you're an introvert, struggle with social anxiety, or simply want to improve your interactions, the exercises in this chapter are for you. Even natural extroverts can benefit from practicing the skills we'll cover! Taking it Step by Step (for those with Social Anxiety): If

social anxiety holds you back, we'll break things down into manageable steps. The goal is to live fully in each interaction, without being overwhelmed by fear. This doesn't mean your anxiety will magically disappear. You can choose to act despite it, or focus your attention on finding joy in the present moment. Important Notes: No forced conversations are required in the activities here. If discomfort arises, you can always choose to disengage. Existing fears take time to rewire. With consistent practice, you'll gain confidence. Remember, even seasoned public speakers experience nerves – the difference is how they manage them. Starting interactions with a smile and genuine happiness will help you overcome those initial jitters. Your Journey Starts Here: For some, the thought of a room full of strangers is terrifying. Don't worry, that's not where we're starting. By patiently working through these exercises, not only will such situations become easier, but you might even find yourself thriving in them! Practice Makes Perfect: The more you practice these skills, the faster you'll see progress and feel a true sense of ease in social settings. Let's get started with the first exercise!

Smile at a Stranger Exercise

The foundation for positive interactions starts with a simple smile. This first exercise helps you build the "smile first" habit – with both people you know and strangers. To participate, you will need to venture out into a place where you'll encounter others – your workplace, school, the store, anywhere with people. Addressing Potential Worries: Worried about doing smile exercises in public? Don't be! Most people are focused on their own lives, and the exercises are subtle. Even if someone did notice, they'd probably just find it a bit quirky and move on. Let's talk about the 5-Second Rule: Research (and author Mel Robbins) suggests that hesitating for longer than 5 seconds lets your brain invent reasons not to act. We'll use this time limit to make each smile attempt quick and decisive, making taking action easier! Here's a breakdown of the exercise steps: Ring your SmileBell™: Activate that genuine happy feeling.

Imagine: Visualize yourself smiling at someone.

Eye Contact: Make brief eye contact with a stranger.

Respond: If they return eye contact, smile.

Keep Going: Then, continue about your day. Why Imagine First? This might seem odd, but visualizing an action is a powerful brain shortcut. It makes your first real-world attempt feel like your second – boosting comfort and confidence. This technique works in many areas of life, especially when nerves are involved. Remember, communication is a two-way street. If there's no returned eye contact, that's perfectly fine! Simply move along. Success, like a true home run, takes practice. Even the legendary Babe Ruth, the Home Run King, had a record-

breaking number of strikeouts: 1,330 throughout his career! The lesson? Success in your social interactions comes from repeated attempts. Embrace the process – even the moments that don't feel perfect are what ultimately pave the way for those future "social home runs".

Coaching Session 3: Smile at a Stranger Exercise

Your Goal: Embrace "Failure" (and Unexpected Success)! This exercise is about building comfort, not necessarily getting a specific reaction from others. So, your first goal is to have five people not smile back after you initiate eye contact and a smile. Don't be surprised if many people do smile back – that's a positive sign! **Getting Started:** Warm Up: On your way, do your smile exercises and ring your SmileBell™ to get into a happy mindset.

Find Your Targets: Pick out individuals and make brief eye contact.

Imagine & Smile: Visualize a positive interaction, then offer a genuine smile.

Observe & Continue: Notice their reaction, then keep going. Don't take it personally if there's no response!

Overcoming Mental Hurdles: Our brains are wired to dislike uncertainty, especially in social situations. Even though you're aiming for "no smiles back", you might get a lot of positive reactions. This is where persistence matters – those smiles are a good sign, but they don't count towards your goal! **Important Notes:** This exercise isn't about rejection: We're building the habit of smiling first, regardless of the other person's response.

Persistence Pays Off: If it seems like everyone is smiling back, find a different location or try again another day. Remember, the process itself is building your confidence! **Culture Matters:** How people react to smiles varies greatly depending on where you are. A friendly smile in a small town might spark a conversation, while it's more likely to be quickly reciprocated in a bustling city.

Small Talk: Your Next Step in Overcoming Social Anxiety Building on the "Smile at a Stranger" exercise, we'll tackle interaction anxiety with small talk (or as we like to call it, "micro talk"). Introverts, don't worry – this doesn't mean drawn-out conversations! The focus is on brief, positive exchanges that build comfort and pave the way for bigger interactions later. As always, participating means venturing out where there are people. What is Small Talk? Think of it as a quick, friendly check-in. A simple "Good morning" as you pass someone, perhaps followed by "How are you?" is all it takes. Stick to positive statements or questions for optimal effect. **Why Bother?**

Baby Steps to Confidence: Small talk helps you dip your toe into interactions without the pressure of introductions or longer conversations.

Habit Building: Each positive exchange makes the next one easier, reducing anxiety over time.

Coaching Session 4: Small Talk

Your Goal: Embrace "Failure" (and Unexpected Success)! Similar to the previous exercise, the focus here isn't on forcing a long conversation, but on building your comfort level with brief interactions. So, your first goal is to have your small talk go unacknowledged five times. But again, don't be surprised if many people respond – that's a great sign! **Small Talk in Action:** **Warm Up:** On your way, do your smile exercises and ring your SmileBell™ to get into a happy mindset.

Find Your Targets: Pick out individuals and make brief eye contact.

Imagine & Initiate: Visualize yourself confidently delivering your chosen phrase and imagine a positive response. Here are some ideas to get you started: **Simple Greetings:** "Hello!", "Good morning!", "Nice evening!" **Weather-based:** "Beautiful day, isn't it?", "Looks like rain later..."

Compliments: "Love your shoes!", "Cute dog!" (only if genuine) **Smile & Speak:** If they return eye contact, offer a genuine smile and say your phrase.

Observe & Continue: Notice their reaction, then keep going. The key here is taking the initiative!

Important Notes: This exercise isn't about rejection: We're building the habit of starting the exchange, regardless of the other person's response.

Persistence Pays Off: It's normal for some attempts to be met with silence, especially in busy settings. This is part of the process!

Celebrate Successes: Take note of every smile and response you get – proof that positive interactions are possible!

Timeframe: We usually set a timeframe (days or a week) to keep you motivated, depending on how much you're out in the world.

PART I

Verbal Communication

The 4% Rule of Conversation

Most of what people take from an interaction is not your words. 80% of the communication is nonverbal — your body language, facial expression, posture, and how you listen.

That leaves 20% for all spoken words.

Of that verbal 20%, roughly 80% should come from the other person.

That leaves you with about 4% of the total interaction as actual talking time. In the practice of human communication, your spoken words should play a strategic role rather than dominating the conversation. A good rule of thumb is that words make up no more than 20% of the interaction. This leaves the large majority for your body language and for the other person to do the talking. What remains for you is a focused and powerful 4% for your verbal communication. Don't worry if that sounds limited — this book is a practical guide to using that small percentage of words to start conversations that get the other person fired up and genuinely interested in talking with you. Your nonverbal communication — body language,

facial expressions, and how you listen — speaks volumes. By being fully present and engaged, you convey interest and create rapport even with minimal verbal input. Actively listen, notice the undercurrents, and ask thoughtful questions that guide the other person to express themselves. This turns the interaction into a dynamic exchange where both people feel heard and valued. This book will also show you how to control and improve that nonverbal side so it consistently works in your favor. There will be moments that call for more talking on your part — sharing a story, giving information, or responding at greater length. For the majority of interactions, especially early ones, following the 4% rule sets the stage for deeper connection. It also reduces the pressure to constantly invent something to say, which is useful when social anxiety shows up.

CHAPTER 3

Verbal Communication

Conversations are the building blocks of human connection. Whether it's a casual chat with a neighbor, a deep discussion with a friend, or a professional presentation – how you communicate shapes every interaction. Forget fearing awkward silences or running out of things to say! Imagine having a framework that empowers you to engage in meaningful conversations with anyone, in any setting. Your genuine smile, fueled by your SmileBell™, is the foundation – and we'll provide the rest. We'll break down the elements of effective conversations, giving you a toolset for creating rapport and keeping the conversation flowing naturally.

Introductions Block One: Names

Names resonate deeply with each of us. Beyond our own name, those of our loved ones, children, even cherished pets carry special significance. Think about the joy you feel when someone remembers your dog's name, or asks about your family members by name. It shows they genuinely care about what's important to you. Imagine being the one to give others that feeling! Nametags are an absolute lifesaver! If you find names slipping your mind (and we all do sometimes), don't worry. There are techniques to help, and as you get more comfortable interacting, you'll be surprised at how quickly your recall improves. Imagine walking into a room and having people greet you by name – a true sign of connection! Even better, you'll be able to return the favor. Your ability to remember names will naturally grow with practice! It's crucial to prioritize honesty over avoiding awkwardness. If you don't remember someone's name, it's far better to ask than to fumble through a conversation. A simple, genuine apology and request will make a good impression: "I'm so sorry, could you remind me of your name?" This shows you care about getting it right and builds trust far more effectively than pretending to know. Remembering names can be tricky sometimes! Did you know that the name itself is often only a tiny part of how we store someone's identity in our minds? Don't worry, with a few simple techniques, you'll create much stronger associations that make their name stick. Here's how:

Ask: If a person doesn't introduce themselves after your initial greeting ("Hi, I'm Reader, where are you from?"), politely ask directly: "And what's your name?" **Repeat:** Immediately use their name back: "Hi Sarah, nice to meet you! What do you do here in Chicago?" **Mental Repetition:** While talking, silently repeat their name to yourself several times, focusing on their face.

Build Associations: Mentally add descriptive details to their name: "Sarah from Chicago, works in marketing, loves hiking, has a purple scarf." The more specific, the better!

Take Notes: If possible, jot down those details alongside their name, or add them to their contact information.

Photo Power: Most phones have a photo option within contacts – use it! Linking a face to the name aids recall. **Practice at Events:** Once you're comfortable, play the "Name Game" at events: Introduce yourself to a small group, then intentionally re-introduce yourself a few minutes later, recalling their names and the details you associated with each person. Names are powerful tools for connection! Using them consistently signals respect, shows you're genuinely invested in the interaction, and makes people feel valued. Imagine being greeted with "Hi Sarah, how's your week going?" Contrast that with a generic "Hey, how are you?" The difference is noticeable, and builds a much stronger impression. This simple practice strengthens personal relationships and can even enhance your professional reputation. The more you use names, the easier it gets – until it becomes second nature and sets you apart as someone who truly cares! **Block One Example Introductions:** The Classic: Smiling and making eye contact, you confidently say: "Hi, I'm Jonah. What's your name?" With Observation: Smiling and making eye contact: "Hi, I'm Jonah. Love your pin, is that from [Place/Event]?" Shared Context: Smiling and making eye contact: "Hi, I'm Jonah. Enjoying the presentation so far? What brings you here today?"

Introductions Block Two: Comments

Now that you're mastering smiles and names, let's give your introductions more depth. While swapping names can work in some settings, everyday interactions need a stronger spark. Think of it as building a bridge for genuine connection! All conversations are about exchanging value – there has to be a reason for both of you to engage. With friends, this bridge forms naturally. Now, let's create a simple structure to make those connections anywhere: Comment, Introduction, Question. **Types of Comments:** Compliments: Sincere remarks on appearance, possessions, or achievements. Remember, choose wisely based on the setting to make people feel noticed and appreciated. Observations: Neutral remarks about something interesting you've spotted – a unique accessory, a book they're reading, or something related to an event. Perfect when compliments might not be suitable. References: Comments that connect to the shared context. For example, at a conference: "Great insights in that last presentation! What did you think?" **The Comment Formula:** A simple structure helps! Start with your observation, add a positive intensifier, and end with an adjective or short phrase. Examples: Compliment: "That pin looks really unique!" Observation: "Interesting book you're reading!" Reference: "Your presentation was excellent!"

On Compliments

When sincere, a well-chosen compliment can make someone's day! It's a simple way to show you've noticed something positive and make them feel appreciated. This naturally strengthens connections and makes people more receptive to conversation. Choosing Wisely: Consider your setting! Compliments on appearance might be welcomed among friends but feel inappropriate in the workplace or certain social situations.

The Compliment Formula: Start with a specific observation, add a sincere intensifier, and end with a positive adjective: Example: "Your presentation was really insightful!" Categories: Appearance (cautiously), Accessories, Achievements, Positive Actions, etc.

Specificity Matters: Empty or generic compliments can backfire. "You look great today!" means more to someone who's made an effort with their appearance. Be observant!

Reading Responses: Some people might deflect a compliment. Don't be discouraged, it's often a sign of their own insecurity, not about your intention.

On Observations

Sometimes a compliment might not feel appropriate, or you may struggle to find the right words. That's where observations come in. This simple habit sharpens your focus and helps you find genuine ways to connect. The rule: point at a third-party object, event, or similarity — the book, the dog, the line, the shirt, the thing you are both standing in front of. You are not evaluating the person. You are talking about the thing. That is safer than a compliment and easier than a blank "so, what do you do?" Observation Practice: Start noticing 7 unique things about people you encounter. This could be anything — a colorful scarf, an interesting book title, a friendly smile. The key is specificity. Benefits beyond compliments: Instant observation can lead to great compliments. Its real power is making you a more attentive conversationalist. You will get better at spotting shared interests and asking relevant questions. Same tool starts the intro and keeps the talk going.

Coaching Yourself: Instant Observation

Ready to sharpen those observation skills? Let's play a game!

The Basic Challenge: Location: Choose a place where you'll encounter people (coffee shop, park, etc.) The Goal: For each person you see, try to identify 7 unique things about them within a few seconds.

Make It Fun: Think of it like a scavenger hunt – accessories, clothing details, what they're carrying, anything interesting!

Level Up: Add Names: If you're introducing yourself, use the name recall techniques from

earlier!

Group Challenge: At events, try recalling details about groups you've met. Can you remember everyone's names and a unique fact about each person?

Speed Test: Once you get good, time yourself! How quickly can you spot those 7 details?

Key Points: Start Simple: It gets easier with practice!

No Judgment: This is about noticing, not critiquing.

Builds Connection: This skill makes you a better listener and conversationalist!

On Strangers vs People You Already Know

For acquaintances, you see often; you would begin noticing changes. Once you work on observing unique things about strangers you will begin to notice similar things about those around you. When those things change you will be able to pick them out. In cases where compliments may be inappropriate they are replaced with simple observations. Be it a professional setting or where the change isn't a positive one. This is easily noted by an acquaintance showing up on crutches, naturally your first question may be "what happened?" Other times it's at professional events where you would comment on the person's affiliation "Your with xyz corp." Comment, Introduction, Question is easy to remember and use and is the goto greeting for humans. You enjoy compliments, as do others. For Block Three we'll fill in the Question part of Comment, Introduction, Question to make our introduction lead into a conversation. Block two example introduction: Smiling and making eye contact. "Hi, I like your eyebrows, I'm Jonah; what are you studying?" "Hi, I love your shoes, I'm Jonah; where are you from?" "Is that How to Win Friends and Influence People? I'm Jonah. Did it hold up?"

Introductions Block Three: FORM

You are now going to build on your introduction structure, which starts with a Compliment or Observation, then an introduction by name, followed by a question or questions. You are going to add a set of basic questions. We borrow from the widely used conversation structure F.O.R.M. taught in many sales circles. F.O.R.M. stands for Family Occupation Recreation Myself or Message. Below is an example snippet from a sales training showing the categories of questions. In a typical conversation you would ask a question about family then occupation then recreation.

Family

Where are you from, Name?

Where did you go to high school or college?

Do you have children? How Old?

Are you married?

Occupation

What kind of work do you do?

What do you like about your job?

How long have you been working there?

How did you get started in that field?

Recreation

What kind of things do you do for fun?

Where would you like to vacation if money was not required?

What are some of your favorite places in the world?

What do you do to relieve stress?

What's the most exciting thing you've ever done?

Our introduction modifies F.O.R.M. to F.F.O.R. From, Family, Occupation and Recreation. No need to remember this yet. So our introduction structure in block three is: Compliment, Introduction, Question about (Where are they From, Do they have Family there, What's their Occupation, What do they do for Recreation)

Below is a very abbreviated snippet of an actual conversation, we'll add more parts to this as we move through the blocks:

Smiling and making eye contact. "Hi, I like your shirt. I'm Jonah. Where are you from?" "Oh, thank you. I just got it; I'm Sam, from Tallahassee." "Nice to meet you. Sam from Tallahassee. Do you have family there?" "Nice to meet you as well, Jonah. My parents are actually from Michigan." ... "What do you do in Tallahassee?" ♪ "I'm a paralegal for a law firm." ... "And what do you like to do when you are not paralegal-ing Sam?" "Scuba diving and collecting rocks!" ... "Well it was nice to meet you Sam"

In your mind you just met Sam the Scuba diving paralegal from Tallahassee. Which is much more memorable than just "Sam".

Sometimes you will get more abbreviated answers such as “oh cool! I like rocks/scuba diving” or “I know xyz from a geographical region or city, have you ever been up there?” Both of these responses leave an opening for continued conversation and interaction.

Notice the other person's name was repeated as well as building a memorable description for them. “Sam the scuba-diving paralegal from Tallahassee.” That little tidbit would be great to store as a contact name, so you always remember Name, location, and how you met. The more you repeat someone's name in a conversation, the more it will stick in your mind, along with building a memorable description and repeating other things about them. If you got a text message from “Sam the scuba-diving paralegal from Tallahassee” you would remember the person who was texting you.

You might wonder why you would ask someone in your hometown, “where are you from?” Why not? Are they from the same neighborhood as you? Do they live on your street or ward? Maybe they are from somewhere you used to live and are traveling through your town.

Sometimes you also need to ask where are you located now? Or where are you from originally? As the generic “where are you from?” can result in some confusion.

This structure is deliberately simple: the package of name occupation/hobby distinctive detail and location is easier to store and recall from memory and takes someone from a stranger into a person you can follow up with.

Introductions Block Four: Dreams

Your introduction up to this point has been very factual. What’s your name, where are you from, what do you do, what do you do for fun. It doesn’t get the imagination going or tell you anything you couldn’t find on an average person's social media profile. You want your conversations to inspire some passion in the person you are speaking with. You do this by adding a final question which encompasses hopes, dreams, goals, and desires -- all of these words cover things people have accomplished or want to have accomplished. To do this we add dreams as the last question in our structured introduction. What has Name done, and what do they hope to have done in the future.

The things people are -- Name, Location, Profession, Degree, Hobbies -- give you a base knowledge of the person. Knowing these things helps you determine if they are similar to you. People's hopes, dreams, goals, and desires; tell you about who they are and who they hope to become as an individual. People are happy to discuss their hopes, dreams, goals, accomplishments. These portions of a person's life bring them joy, happiness, hope, and passion.

Here's an expanded snippet of the previous conversation: Smiling and making eye contact. "Hi, I like your shirt. I'm Jonah. Where are you from?" "Oh, thank you. I just got it; I'm Sam, I'm from Tallahassee." "Nice to meet you. Sam from Tallahassee. Do you have family there?" "Nice to meet you as well, Jonah. My parents are actually from Michigan." ... "What do you do in Tallahassee?" ♪ "I'm a paralegal for a law firm." ... "And what do you like to do when you are not paralegal-ing Sam?" "Scuba diving and collecting rocks!" ... "Are you working to move up from being a paralegal or maybe becoming a world champion scuba diver?" ♪ "I'm going to school for nursing." ... "Well it was nice to meet you Sam the Scuba diving paralegal from Tallahassee."

You can see some of Sam's hopes, dreams, goals or desires. Sam has achieved becoming a paralegal, scuba diving, and enrolling in a degree program. Sam hopes and dreams of becoming a nurse.

Up to this point our introduction is more of a quick interview. It's mostly one way. There is one more block to cover that will take our guide from an introduction to a conversation.

Introductions Block Five: Conversation

From, Family, Occupation, Recreation, Dreams all tell you something about the person. This isn't yet a conversation. We have one more block to add. Human beings, at one point or another, lived in small groups, then larger groups. Other groups would fight to claim resources from the first group. Because of this, people like people who are similar to themselves. People like people with whom they can relate or connect. As a general rule of conversation, every statement someone makes about their life or themselves, you will make a connecting statement, share a likeness or appreciation, then inquire or ask a question again. You will respond to each answered question with what connects the person, place, or thing, in the answer, to yourself. Stating how you share a likeness to the answer. Then asking a follow-up or different question, making another inquiry about them. Without this, connect, share likeness, inquire format, you are interviewing someone not having a conversation with them.

This is an interview: Where are you from? Tallahassee.

What do you do? Paralegal.

What do you do for fun? Scuba Dive.

You connect with them by relating what they said to yourself or your life experience: "What do you do?" "I'm a Paralegal at a Law Firm." All of these are connecting statements: My cousin is an attorney. I used to be a Paralegal. To be honest I have no clue what a paralegal does. Oh so you do all of the heavy lifting. Etc.

You share likeness with them with an equivalent statement or answer about yourself: “What do you do?” “I’m a Paralegal at a Law Firm.” “My cousin is an attorney, I’m a civil engineer.”

You inquire by asking a followup question. “What do you do?” “I’m a Paralegal at a Law Firm.” “My cousin is an attorney, I’m a civil engineer. What do you do for fun?”

Sometimes you connect and share likeness by just inquiring or asking a follow-up question which shows interest before moving back to the same connect, share likeness, then inquire format: “What do you do?” “I’m a Paralegal at a Law Firm.” What law firm? What does a paralegal do? How did you get into that line of work? These are all follow up inquiries which show interest in the other person.

People like people who are similar to themselves, so we as communicators share our likeness. And the more the other person knows about you, the more they will be willing to share with you, which will make the entire conversation more enjoyable.

People like people who are similar to themselves.

The more we share about ourselves with someone, the more they will share in return.

Take another look at our conversation snippet from the previous block.

Smiling and making eye contact. “Hi, I like your shirt. I’m Jonah. Where are you from?” “Oh, thank you. I just got it; I’m Sam, I’m from Tallahassee.” “Nice to meet you. Sam from Tallahassee. Do you have family there?” “Nice to meet you as well, Jonah. My parents are actually from Michigan.” ... “What do you do in Tallahassee?” ♪ “I’m a paralegal for a law firm.” ... “And what do you like to do when you are not paralegal-ing Sam?” “Scuba diving and collecting rocks!” ... “Are you working to move up from being a paralegal or maybe becoming a world champion scuba diver?” ♪ “I’m going to school for nursing.” ... “Well it was nice to meet you Sam the Scuba diving paralegal from Tallahassee.”

This conversation leaves a lot more questions than answers and is one-sided. Sam doesn’t know where you live or have lived. Sam only knows that they are talking to Jonah. You also don’t know much about Sam, for example: Does Sam have any siblings? How and why did Sam start SCUBA diving? What kind of rocks does Sam collect? Does Sam have anything in common with You? Why did Sam move to Florida? So many questions. It’s like you left the plot out of the movie. If you are to remember Sam or have Sam remember you, you’ll need a bit more information shared. In many cases, you will talk to people and the conversation will flow like this snippet. The person will respond to questions with single sentences and won’t ask followup questions. As the communicator, you will be leading the conversation to make it interactive, bi-directional, fun, and memorable.

Here is a longer snippet of that conversation using the current introduction structure with the Connect, Likeness, Inquiry structure added: Smiling and making eye contact. “Hi, I like your shirt. I’m Jonah. Where are you from?” “Oh, thank you. I just got it; I’m Sam, I’m from Tallahassee.” “Nice to meet you, Sam from Tallahassee. What a small world, I just went on vacation in Tallahassee last year, and I’m From Michigan. Do you have family in Tallahassee?” “Nice to meet you as well, Jonah, Michigan really? My parents are actually from Michigan.” ... The conversation branches to what part of Michigan and Why the visit to Tallahassee after which we circle back ... “What do you do in Tallahassee Sam?” ♪ “I’m a paralegal for a law firm.” “No kidding, my friend was a paralegal. I manage a 3D printing shop. So what do you like to do for fun when you are not paralegal-ing?” ... The conversation branches to 3D printing after which we circle back... “And what do you like to do when you are not paralegal-ing Sam?” “Scuba diving and collecting rocks!” ... If anyone ever tells you they collect rocks or something that sounds obscure or different to you, ask lots of questions. I’m fascinated by hobbies I find uncommon so I Inquired a lot after which we circle back... “...and Scuba diving, wow I’ve never been though I’ve been thinking about getting into it, I do a lot of reading, and I’m working on a skydiving license. Are you working to move up from being a paralegal or maybe becoming a world champion scuba diver?” ♪ “... I’m going to school for nursing.” ... “Well it was nice to meet you Sam the Scuba diving paralegal from Tallahassee.”

You can see that this conversation was interactive and ended up in discussions about certain aspects that we had in common, it was about our likenesses, and each of us discussed our passions, hobbies, hopes and dreams. The structured introduction is what brought up each of those points allowing us to end up in those parts of the conversation. And the Connect, share Likeness, then Inquire format is what kept the conversation going.

Introductions Block Six: Clifford

The acronym C.L.I.F.F.O.R.D. stands for Compliment Introduction From Family Occupation Recreation Dreams additionally the first three letters stand for Connect, share Likeness, Inquire.

CLIFFORD is your loose introduction and verbal conversation structure, meaning you sometimes skip parts of it or change the order; the conversation can flow naturally. When you are walking through CLIFFORD, you will often hit on something that you and the other person have in common as seen in the previous examples, which will branch the conversation. That is one of the reasons you use CLIFFORD. If you make it to the end of CLIFFORD, your conversation will be a series of Connect, share Likeness, Inquire.

When should you use the CLIFFORD structured introduction and conversation? When you talk to another human. Have you known someone for five years? Run through CLIFFORD and see what you learn. Bump into someone who you perceive as being similar to you at the grocery store? Run through CLIFFORD with them and see if you want to keep the conversation going.

In small groups, you may run an entire group through CLIFFORD and then ask individual follow-up questions. “Where is everybody from?”

This structure will get into conversations and we have one more block to cover. How do you get out of the conversation?

Introductions Block Seven “Coffee is for Closers”

~Glengarry Glen Ross 1992 Film

When you go out and start having conversations with people, they have to end at some point. What if you are enjoying the conversation? What if you are running out of things to say? What if you want to go to a game or a professional event with this person?

In its simplest form, closing a conversation looks like this:

“Well it was nice to meet you Sam the Scuba diving paralegal from Tallahassee. I have to get going now, can we continue this conversation later?”

Or at a professional event “I have to get going now, do you have a card?”

The beauty of this is in its simplicity. Either you and the other person both enjoyed the conversation, or you didn’t. If you both enjoyed the conversation, the response would be straightforward:

“Yes, I’d like that!”

At which point, you pull out your phone or a napkin and a pen or something else and get some form of contact information for the other party.

A shortcut for when you know a conversation is drawing to a close. Put your phone or writing utensil in your hand and have it up when you say, “can we continue this at a later time,” it’s an obvious indicator that you would like to swap contact information. What if you don’t want to continue the conversation?

“Well, Sam From Tallahassee, this has been a great conversation. I have to get going now.”

What if they don't want to continue the conversation?

*“Well, Sam From Tallahassee, this has been a great conversation. I have to get going now.
Can we continue this later?”*

“Maybe we'll run into each other again sometime.”

When to Use CLIFFORD?

Always and within the first 3-7 seconds. 3 5 7 Seconds Verbal communication is a conversation. When someone answers a question you asked, a conversation starts. You don't need ten, twenty, ninety-two, or one-thousand topics to hold a conversation. You only need to know how to start a conversation and continue it, the CLIFFORD model provides this. The content of the conversation is directly in front of you in the other person's brain.

If you already know someone, the conversation will be an update on everything in CLIFFORD. The vast majority of non-fact exchanging conversation is right here:

Names: How are they? Their children, their pets, their friends, etc.

From: Have they moved? Traveled, Remodeled, Cut the lawn, etc.

Family: Has their family changed? Expanded, Contracted, Moved, etc.

Occupation: How is their work, business, side hustle?

Recreation: Have they done the things they enjoy doing for recreation? Hobbies, Sports, Movies, Religion, Politics, etc.

Dreams: How are they progressing toward their goals? Have they achieved anything recently?

Knowing these intuitive and straightforward things, you can hold conversations for hours with people you know and strangers. Instead of learning ninety-nine topics to talk about, you will now learn how to enhance your regular verbal communication to draw people in.

CHAPTER 4

The Power of Verbal Communication and Words

The Monster Study

In an unethical study in 1939 researcher Wendell Johnson and grad student Mary Tudor ran an experiment on 22 Orphan children. Some children who spoke without a stutter were repeatedly criticized and told their speech was defective and that they stuttered. Other children who did have a stutter were praised and told their speech was fine.

The result: several of the normally fluent children developed lasting speech problems and negative self-perception around talking. Words alone were enough to damage how they spoke and how they felt about speaking.

“A Slip of the Foot you may soon recover: But a Slip of the Tongue you may never get over.”
~Benjamin Franklin

The old saying “sticks and stones may break my bones but words will never hurt me” has been proven false over and over. Words shape self-concept, performance, behavior and can create long term health affects much worse than a bruise or broken bone. Words can create limits or remove them. That is why the language habits in this chapter and the next matter to both you and anyone you converse with. The words you use on yourself and on other people have power and are not neutral.

Names

This bears repeating. It is important to use people's names when interacting with them, as names are significant and can help establish a personal connection. This includes using their pets' names and the names of their children or cars. Using someone's name shows that you are paying attention and are interested in them, and it can make them feel valued and appreciated. In fact, using someone's name can even help improve their memory of you and the conversation you had. So, be sure to use people's names when interacting with them, and if you don't know their name, be sure to ask for it.

The Name Game

The author has dealt with and heard from many others that names are difficult for some to remember. In addition to using CLIFFORD in order to build a memorable description to go with a person's name you can also play the name game.

In its simplest form you go to a place where people gather, introduce yourself and start collecting names, then go back later and see if you remembered their names correctly.

Repetition improves recall speed and accuracy. Play it at events, meetups, or any setting where you will see the same people again after a short gap. The skill compounds with volume.

Language to Remove

Can't

“Can’t” is one of the most damaging words in everyday language. It functions as both a limiting belief and an excuse. When you say “I can’t,” you are often really saying “I am not going to try” or “I am afraid of the result.”

Treat it the way some people treat swearing. Notice it. Catch it. Replace it. A practical tool: keep a “can’t jar.” Every time the word appears, note it. Prefer “I haven’t learned how yet,” “I don’t know how to do that yet,” or “I am not willing to do that right now.”

The word is powerful enough that hearing it from someone else can instantly change performance. One example: a child was swimming across the pool. His brother yells, “Hey, what are you doing—you can’t swim!” The child immediately stops being able to swim and starts going under. He didn’t know he could swim in the first place; he had never tried without a life jacket. His brain already had the motor pattern, but the moment the external voice declared “you can’t,” the brain accepted the constraint and the body followed. It was instant. Most of the sudden collapses people describe work the same way. They are comparable to Wile E. Coyote running off the cliff and only falling when he looks down. He could keep going through midair until the limitation is acknowledged. The same thing happens with “can’t.” The moment it is accepted—by you or by someone speaking it over you—the performance drops. Removing the word “can’t” produces a drastic effect and is one of the highest-payoff verbal changes you can make.

Impossible

After teaching people to remove the word “can’t,” we found that some individuals simply replaced it with “impossible.” So the same advice now applies to both.

Never use the word “impossible.”

“Impossible” is just a limiting belief. When you use it, you are essentially saying that you are unable to do something and that you are powerless to change the situation. Saying something is impossible is a self-fulfilling prophecy. You are telling yourself you are unable to do it and that you are doomed to fail.

Anything is possible as long as you are willing to work and persevere. Instead of declaring something impossible, focus on what you can do and keep working to overcome the challenges in front of you. By refusing the word, you maintain a constructive mindset and stay focused on the next step rather than on a closed door.

This is the language side of the same idea covered at the beginning of Chapter 2 in Impossible! — the mindset version. Here we are only removing the word. Refuse both “can’t” and “impossible.” The language shift is small. The effect on what you attempt is not.

Complaining

Complaining is a waste of time and energy. It does nothing to improve your situation or your health. When you complain, you are essentially saying that you are helpless and powerless and that you are unable to do anything to improve your situation. It is a form of victimhood and a form of negative self-talk. You are telling yourself that you cannot overcome the challenge and that you are doomed to fail.

Spending time complaining means you are not accomplishing anything. You are not making the thing you are complaining about any better. Go do something instead of complaining about something.

By refusing to complain, you take control of your own life and create the conditions most likely to lead to success. Success is whatever you want. Goals are whatever you want. When you stop putting time, energy, and effort into saying negative things about your situation or someone else’s, you maintain a constructive mindset and stay focused on whatever it is you actually want. The more successful you become, the less you have to complain about—and the less you complain.

Take action: The next time you or someone around you starts to complain, stop or walk away. Take back control of your self-confidence and self-talk.

Language to Add/Change

Positive Words

This should be obvious. Unfortunately it isn't. In your regular daily speech and writing, use more pleasurable and positive words. People will run from the negative with twice the effort they will run toward the positive. This is simple. Just pick a positive word and look up synonyms:

Love: appreciation – devotion – fondness – passion – delight – enchantment – enjoyment – inclination – regard – admire – adore – approve – cherish – savor

Good: excellent – exceptional – favorable – great – marvelous – positive – satisfying – superb – valuable – wonderful – nice – pleasing

These are just some words you can throw into your regular everyday speech. They can also replace negative words you currently use. Make an effort to replace negative words with positive words even mid-sentence. “I really ha... enjoy it when the roads are clear of accidents.” Replacing negative words will cause you to focus on the positive, and that will make you notice the positive, which will make you happier overall.

When speaking, you want others to enjoy what you have to say and desire to hear what you are saying. It doesn't matter if you are in a board meeting, out with family, spending time with friends, or talking to a stranger. Using positive words and synonyms—Love, Like, Pleasure, Awesome, Good, Fantastic—will make your regular speaking more appealing to those listening.

Swap But with And

Replace the word “but” with the word “and.” In everyday language, “but” indicates argument. “I understand that you believe, but...” is the beginning of an argument.

Try: “I understand that you believe, and I believe.” Now you have agreed with someone and added your point of view.

This is especially useful for employers and managers. “You want this, but I think we should do this” is how an argument starts and how people get insulted.

Say instead: “You want to do this, and I want to do this.” Most people are used to the frame

“you have this idea, but we’re going to do it my way.” Replacing “but” with “and” changes that frame. First you actively listen. Someone brings an idea. You repeat it back: “I understand that you want the flyers to be blue.

And I think it would match our company colors better if there was some shade of red.” A related shift works the same way. Instead of saying “I’m sorry for being late,” say “Thank you for being patient with me being late.” Thank them for their patience instead of apologizing. Small word. Massive result.

Positive reinforcement Positive reinforcement in conversation is the deliberate highlighting of useful behavior so that behavior becomes more likely to repeat. The science behind it is the same conditioning already used in this book, plus the rule that humans run from the negative with twice the energy they run toward the positive. Criticism suppresses. Absence of response extinguishes. Specific appreciation increases the rate of the desired action.

Practical form:

Name the exact behavior

Link it to a clear positive effect

Deliver it close in time to the behavior

Examples: “Thank you for sending the summary before the meeting—it let us start on time.” “You’re always so organized” is too vague to steer future action. “Thanks for taking the trash out—it saved me a trip and the kitchen doesn’t smell.” “I appreciate you doing the dishes right after dinner—it kept the sink clear and made the evening easier.” Used consistently, positive reinforcement changes the emotional climate of a relationship or a team faster than almost any other verbal habit. It is the active counterpart to the removal of expectation, which we cover in the next chapter. You stop punishing the baseline and start amplifying what you actually want more of.

CHAPTER 5

The Second of the “3 Things” Gratitude

The Three Things are a timeline tool from the broader Invocation system: Forgiveness — clear the past so it stops steering the present. You don't have to pretend it didn't happen; you just stop letting old damage run your conversations.

Gratitude — occupy the present without the weight of unspoken expectations. That's the second of the three, and it's what this chapter is about.

Something to do — give the future a concrete direction: a next step with a destination and a clock, so you're moving toward something instead of just meaning to.

This chapter is about that second piece: gratitude as the operating system for how you speak to and about other people.

Two questions help lock the frame: Would someone want to talk to me more if they liked what I was saying?

Would I enjoy talking to someone more if I was pleased by what they were saying?

Gratitude

The most powerful change you can make to your verbal communications is to show gratitude. Showing more gratitude in your regular daily speech and writing will cause others to show you more gratitude and will improve your mood and self esteem. The positive use of gratitude is showing or giving appreciation and thanks. The opposite of showing gratitude is ingratitude which is simply the lack of showing gratitude. People will run from the negative with twice the energy as they run towards the positive. This means people put twice as much energy avoiding ingratitude as they do seeking gratitude.

Gratitude according to Merriam-Webster is the quality of being thankful; readiness to show appreciation and return kindness. The Merriam-Webster definition of ingratitude is a discernable lack of gratitude. That means to the brain there is a level below ingratitude as by default, not showing gratitude is the negative form. There is an even lower form of ingratitude, criticism which will push people away with four times the energy which showing gratitude will draw them in.

Here is a table to demonstrate:

Gratitude	+1	Draws people in.
Avoidance	0	Neutral
Ingratitude	-2	Pushes people away with twice the energy
Criticism	-4	Pushes people away with four times the energy

On average, a person you don't show gratitude to has no real reason to interact with you. A person who you often criticize has plenty of reason to avoid you. A person to whom you show gratitude and appreciation has a reason to interact with you more often.

Removing Expectations

Gratitude is simple. Remove any and all expectations in your head, and replace them with thanks and appreciation. Sound complicated? It isn't. Go to a drive-thru and order a coffee. You expect the person there to take your money and get you a coffee. Remove that expectation. Now you are thankful that the person brought you a coffee. So you will say, "Oh, thank you." Your baseline expectation is nothing. Not "an employee is going to show up and do their job." Not "your spouse is going to do the dishes." When something happens, you are grateful for it. Removing expectations does not prevent a job from getting done, a goal from being reached, or a deadline from being met. You can still give negative feedback. You can still fire people. You can still lose friends. You just stop treating the baseline as a debt they already owe you. If you only enforce the negative — "you were late today" — and never the positive — "thank you for staying late," "thank you for working an extra day" — you become someone people avoid. They will do the bare minimum to stay out of the way of your criticism. The boss nobody wants to talk to, the coworker who makes you cringe, the parent who only notices what went wrong: same pattern. Expectation creates negative communication and ingratitude. If you expect nothing, you can be grateful for everything. Remove the expectation. Say thanks.

Expectation vs Communication

Have you ever wondered why you aren't on the same page? You did something with or for another person, and they were unhappy with the result. Someone told you they would do something, and they didn't. Agreements need to be specific and time-based. Not the whole SMART list — not achievable, not relevant. Destination and a clock. If you cannot tell whether you landed, you did not agree. You expected. If you take an airplane and you put

two sets of controls on it and you say all right, you're both pilots at the same time. You can fly to the same place — or you crash a multi-million dollar airplane. If you both want to go different places, or arrive at different times, you can both get on different planes. Or you agree the plane can stop at both places. The passengers — kids, pets, anyone along for the ride — have every reason to expect you to go from point A to point B at a specified time. They're just along for the ride. The two of you don't need to expect A to B at a specified time. That's the passengers' job. Your job is to agree on the destination and when you will be there. There should have been clear communication before you ever took off or boarded the plane about where (what) and when you needed to be at that destination. It's when you think you're arriving here at this time and they think you're arriving there at this other time — they expect this, you expect that — now you have an expectation divergence. Divergence means you are running two different pictures of the same trip and calling it one plan. If you talk about it first, and you both know exactly where you're going and when you're arriving, you're either going to go here at this time or you're getting on a separate plane. That's communication. When you don't communicate about it, it's an expectation. Neither one of you would have had a problem being over there at that time. You just didn't know that that's where you were supposed to be.

Gratitude Expanded

You already know the move. Baseline expectations are out. When something happens, you say thank you. Now throw that at everything.

Turn on a light switch. Stop expecting it to work. Not everybody has a light switch that works. Be grateful when the room lights up.

Drink water. Be grateful you can. Get in a car and drive down the road. Be grateful for the car. Be grateful for the road. Be grateful there are lines painted on it. Someone decided a stripe down the middle would keep people from hitting each other. That is worth thanks.

Wake up. Be grateful you woke up. You are breathing. Be grateful for that. If you are not dead, you have something to be grateful for. If things currently suck, you still have something. The point is not to fake a mood. The point is to stop treating ordinary functioning as a debt the world owes you. Same rule at work and at home. Your friend did not have to go to that show with you. Your employee could have stayed home or taken another job. When they show up, that is not the baseline. That is something that happened. Name it. Showing gratitude in speech is not decoration. It removes criticism and ingratitude from the default. People have more reasons to spend time with you. They have more reasons to provide value — help, buy, work, stay late, stay your manager, stay in the conversation. Get rid of the running critique and more people talk about you in a positive way when you are not in the room. You can still ask. Ask three times, five times, ten times. Asking is communication.

Expecting them to already know is not. If you wanted to borrow a plane, you would not sit there expecting someone to offer it. You would ask until you got a yes or you changed the plan. Blatantly be grateful for what actually occurred. Then ask for what you want next. That is the expanded habit: throw the same concept at the light switch, the road, the coworker, the stranger, and the person you live with.

Health Benefits of Gratitude

To some the last section will seem corny or soft or touchy-feely. There is a tangible real-world benefit to gratitude: your health. When you live on expectation and criticism, the body stays in fight-or-flight. Heart rate up. Sleep thin. Everything reads as a problem. Remove the expectation and say the thanks, and that alarm spends less time running. People who practice gratitude sleep better. They report less daily stress when they list what went right instead of what went wrong. In some medical groups, a simple gratitude journal moved inflammatory markers in the direction of recovery. Self-confidence and better treatment from other people are part of the same loop. More support. Less isolation. Fight-or-flight gets used for actual problems instead of for the coworker who merely did their job. Boundaries are an expectation if you do not communicate them. Nothing in this practice of gratitude stops you from setting a deadline or firing someone. This is not softness. It is taking the body out of fight-or-flight except in the moments that actually require it.

PART II

Nonverbal Communication

The Science of Nonverbal Communication

Human communication consists of three distinct types of communication: verbal, the words you say, vocal, your tone when you say them, and visual, your body language. In part one, you learned to smile, what words to say, how to generate a conversation and specific words that draw people into a conversation. In this part, you will learn how to communicate with your tone and body. You will first learn the science of nonverbal communication through the 7-38-55 rule and the mirror neuron system. Then a structure and method to control your nonverbal communication similar to how you control your verbal communication. Followed by more ways to enhance your overall communications and connectivity with others. When you communicate with others, your goal is to convey genuine happiness, similarity or likeness to the person or people you are communicating with, and a genuine interest without expectation.

The 7-38-55 Rule

In 1967 Dr. Albert Mehrabian and colleagues performed a study on communications to determine the relative impact of tone and spoken words. In the study subjects listened to recorded words conveying liking, neutrality, and disliking, with each of the words spoken in different vocal tones. For instance, “thanks” might be stated in a scolding tone or “maybe” in a happy and friendly tone. The subjects were then asked to guess the emotions behind the words they heard. The experiment found that tone conveys more meaning than the words themselves.

Dr. Mehrabian performed a second study, on communications, in 1967 to determine the relative impact of tone and facial expressions. In this study, subjects listened to the single word “maybe” recorded in three voice tones. The tones conveyed liking, neutrality, and disliking. Subjects looked at photos of faces showing the same three emotions. Each of the subjects guessed the emotions of the recorded voices, the facial expressions in the pictures, and the combination of the facial expressions and recorded voices. The experiment found that facial expressions and visual communications were more accurate by a 3 to 2 ratio.

After conducting these studies, Dr. Mehrabian et al. concluded communications regarding feelings or attitudes are 7% verbal, 38% vocal, and 55% visual. They also caution that this rule does not apply to all communications. Written communication, such as emails, letters,

and books, can convey more than 7% of the desired message and lead to more frequent misunderstandings. You cannot understand 93% of what someone says by simply watching them. However, you will be able to determine their general demeanor.

It is easier to understand words and meaning when you can see and hear a person's nonverbal communication. It is easier to misunderstand words when you cannot. The studies leading to the 7-38-55 rule only tested for tone and facial expressions. The face is only one part of your ability to communicate visually. Your posture, arm movements, positioning of your feet and more all contribute to your visual communications; your entire body conveys meaning. In order to maximize your communications you point your body at the person you are communicating with to increase the amount of your nonverbal communication being displayed.

Several decades after Dr. Mehrabian's studies, researchers made new discoveries that explain why nonverbal communication is crucial; we cover this research in the next section. We also now know the impact of nonverbal communication is stronger when observed in person vs photographs, videos, or recordings. The reason nonverbal communication is so effective at conveying meaning is due to the Mirror Neuron System (M.N.S.). The story of its discovery starts with a monkey from the macaque species, picking up objects.

The Mirror Neuron System

In the late 1980s Giacomo Rizzolatti worked on documenting the movements involving an object. Specifically, the researchers studied which groups of neurons in the brain fire when the monkeys grasp an object. Similar to Pavlov noticing a “psychic secretion” in dogs, Giacomo noticed a strange phenomenon. In addition to the regular neurons, which control motor functions, a separate group of neurons fire when the monkey grasps an object. This second group of neurons also fire when one monkey observes a different monkey grasping an object. The neurons are mirroring the action observed in another animal.

Subsequent research into this phenomenon led Giacomo’s team and others to find a diverse mirror neuron system in monkeys. These neurons mirror what is seen and performed, allowing the brain to experience what other animals do. This mirror neuron system translates the observation of an action being performed into a knowledge of that action, which is called action understanding. Scientists, being curious, eventually looked for the same neurons in humans.

To look for a mirror neuron system in the human brain researchers performed brain imaging studies. These studies involve placing individuals into fMRI and other imaging devices. While monitoring brain activity the individuals are asked to perform certain

actions. They are then shown others performing those same actions. Through this research, an elaborate mirror neuron system was discovered in the human brain. The human mirror neuron system (MNS), unlike the monkeys, also fires while observing seemingly meaningless movements and those not involving tools or objects.

The human MNS is a vast and complex network inside your brain. When you smile, specific neurons fire to make you smile. Simultaneously particular mirror neurons fire. The same mirror neurons fire in your brain when you see someone smile. You experience the other person's smile. When you fake smile or see a fake smile the same thing happens which is why we learned how to genuinely smile in chapter 1. Your MNS also tries to figure out the intention and perceptions of the other person based on their body language and tone of voice. Your brain interprets the emotion, intention, perception and anticipates the actions of the other person; this interpretation is called reading. Reading is when you observe what is visually or tonally communicated by another person and attempt to understand it.

This is why nonverbal communication carries so much weight. The next section shows how emotions move between people through this system.

Emotional Transference and the Power Equation

If you take the number of people in a group: Take those with positive emotions: number of people in a positive mood plus perceived authority of each plus weight of each person's mood Subtract those with negative emotions: number of people in a negative mood plus perceived authority of each plus weight of each person's mood That is the mood the group drifts toward.

That's the power equation. Have you ever been around somebody who is in a really good mood or a really bad mood? Probably both. After spending enough time with them, you start to feel the same way. Every anchor and every emotion works this way. If you add the emotional states of any group of people, the group will gravitate to that state or emotion. Someone can be sad, a group of people can be sad, or one person can be extremely happy and three people can be sad — that one person could make all three of those people happy. Each emotional state has a level or power to it, how happy or sad a person is. Their perceived authority also has a level or power to it. Your positive anchor works the same way. You trigger your smile bell, giving you a positive anchor and filter. If you experience too many negative things in that state, it can break that positive anchor and make it negative. Happens in relationships a lot. People have a positive anchor to someone for sex or for other reasons, and then they can break it. Then when they're around that person, all of a sudden they're in a negative mood. Transference is when you take a state — a very calm state, a very happy state — and transfer it to another person. If you're sitting next to someone in a certain

mood long enough, you'll take that on. You'll start to feel that yourself. If you focus the emotion — happiness, sadness, anger are the easy ones because they are polar — you can be around someone for a period of time and they absorb it. Or you spend a small amount of time, go directly to them, have a conversation. Proximity matters, including scent and hormones, which is why touch and standing close speed it up. Physical touch transfers it a lot faster. Close proximity, eye contact, and physical touch make the whole process happen faster. Laughter's infectious. You're sitting at the bar, somebody tells a joke, you start laughing, you touch the other person, they start laughing harder from that contact. If one person is laughing more and they make physical contact, it moves quicker. Sadness transfers the same way. Funeral, they're crying, you hug them, then you start bawling. You can transfer other things the same way you transfer happiness. The stronger and more focused the state you hold, the more it moves. The room is not the only thing that moves your state. News will also affect your mood, and therefore your nonverbal communication. We'll group those hits under news.

News

Open a newspaper — or the feed on your phone — and scan the day's stories. One is about a rescued animal. One is about a family reunion. One is about three people killed by a drunk driver.

Ask yourself which story you will still remember in two days.

Almost everyone keeps the deaths. Negative events capture and hold attention with about twice the force of positive ones. Humans run from the negative with twice the energy they run toward the positive. That is why one harsh interaction can outweigh several good ones in memory. If you let negative framing, criticism, or complaint dominate your speech, you are using the stronger channel. People will remember it longer and avoid you more strongly. If you want the opposite — approach instead of avoidance — you have to deliberately overweight the positive. There is a related phenomenon with how news hits your mood. If someone delivers bad news and later retracts it, you end up in a better mood than if they had delivered no news at all. The drop happens. Then the relief overshoots the starting point. That is not a reason to manufacture fake news. It is a reason to notice that negative information changes your mood harder than neutral silence. People already, incorrectly, know the compliment sandwich: good, then bad, then good. It is wrong and a bad system. The first good gets treated as padding. The bad is what sticks. The last good is apology frosting. Research on the order you receive news shows this. People who hear the bad and then the good end in a better mood and a cleaner read of what happened than people who only get the bad. End on the good. Or say the bad, then the good, then more good if you have

it. Do not bury the bad between two compliments and call it kindness. Gratitude and positive reinforcement are not soft preferences. They are the counterweight to a system built to prioritize threats.

The Practice of Nonverbal Communication

Smiling is foundational to everything we teach one-on-one and in this book. After smiling, the practice of creating an outcome before a conversation is the next most important. For this book you will learn mental states and framing as the method of creating an outcome. State training is the most effective method to teach in writing. The remainder of this book is based on the practice of smiling, mental states, and framing. You will be applying these techniques to meet and interact with strangers and people you already know.

Mental State

When your body is communicating nonverbally, it communicates your Mental State. Your Mental State consists of your emotions, sensations, intentions, and perceptions and is a billboard displayed by your tone and body language. Changing any part of your Mental State will change the message you communicate.

Your emotion is simply the predominant feeling you are currently experiencing. When meeting people or interacting you will be feeling happy by ringing your SmileBell. Changing your emotion, for example from happiness to sadness will change your body language. Your vocal tone will change. You may physically pull your arms and legs closer to your body making you seem physically smaller. When you are happier you take up more physical space and become more open. You make more eye contact and may talk more rapidly.

Your sensations will show in your body language. When you're cold you shiver, when you're hot you sweat, when you injure your knee or foot you limp. These are your sensations which are displayed nonverbally.

Your intentions are what you plan to do; your intentions show in your verbal and nonverbal communications even when you think they don't. More on this later.

Your Perception is what you think about yourself and the other person. You'll experience more joy speaking to someone you like or admire and more fear or anger talking to someone you dislike. Each of which will show in your verbal and nonverbal communications.

Setting Your Mental State

You know that a Mental State contains emotions, sensations, intentions, and perceptions. An Intentional Mental State is a constructed state you apply to your own mind. This is done using your imagination, attention, and intentional thought. For meeting new people there is a basic template that we teach. This template is for social interactions, personal interactions, professional interactions, and any interaction with another human.

Emotion: Genuinely happy.

Sensations: Comfortable and relaxed.

Intention: Meet someone new and learn how they are similar to you, without expectation.

Perception: The other person is a happy and friendly person who is similar to you.

Your thoughts when you first start intentionally setting your Mental State will be about all of the parts of the State. You will be directing your thoughts and attention to comfort, intentions, and perceptions. This is the main reason you learned the SmileBell and the CLIFFORD structured introduction and conversation format before learning nonverbal communication. You should be able to have an entire interaction while showing genuine interest without using a lot of intentional thought on the topics and format of the conversation. With practice, it will be easier to set your state and your current thoughts will be more on the interaction itself.

Let's review the parts of the Mental State:

Your emotion is easy to handle, you already know how to elicit happiness via your SmileBell, for meeting new people this will be the emotion you set. Using genuine happiness overcomes lack of confidence and any anxiety remaining after the activities in chapter 1.

Your sensations will be fixed based on your environment and how you physically feel. The easiest way to set this is to physically wear comfortable clothing or practice wearing less comfortable dress clothes until you develop comfort. In your mind you can take an inventory of your physical sensations -- touch, taste, smell, sight, sound -- and focus your attention on the most comfortable parts of those senses.

Your intention is to simply have a conversation in order to find out how the other person is similar to you. If you introduce an expectation to the conversation -- looking for drinking buddies, inviting people to religious services, informal political polling, finding a date for an upcoming wedding -- those expectations will show in your intentions. You control your intentions. When setting your State set it with the intention of having a conversation without expectation.

The action of removing expectation also removes the risk of rejection or failure and gives you unlimited self-confidence.

Your perception for setting your Mental State is your perception of the person you are interacting with. The best way to set your perceptions for a stranger is to either think of someone who you like and admire or to remember the five things you're most proud of about yourself. You want to like the people you talk to before you talk to them. This is the template for your Mental State:

Emotion: Happy, ring your SmileBell to elicit happiness.

Sensations: Comfortable, concentrate on the most relaxed feelings.

Intention: Meet someone new and learn how they are similar to you, without expectation.

Perception: The other person is a happy and friendly person who is similar to you. You can set this by either thinking of someone who you like and admire or remembering the five things you're most proud of about yourself.

With practice setting your own Mental State is a simple task. Now we need to Frame the other persons' Mental State.

Framing Their Mental State

"You reap what you sow."

Self-perception is a catch 22 or paradox it goes like this: What you think about yourself is what you believe others think about you.

What you believe others think about you is what others will think about you.

What others think about you becomes what you believe others think about you.

What you believe others think about you is what others will think about you.

It's an infinite loop, a broken record, a never-ending recursion.

In order to fix this problem with the human brain, you can just bypass all of that by creating a frame. A frame is a constructed Mental State of a person containing each of the elements of that Mental State. You already know that a Mental State contains emotions, sensations, intentions, and perceptions. A frame contains these same elements. It is the key that makes liking people and having people like you possible before ever meeting them. Before you ever meet someone you want to like them and have them like you.

When you set your Mental State for interactions, you will include the other person's Framed Mental State under your perception. When Framing a stranger, you don't know the things you will be framing, so it is easy to set the frame and there is no reason to doubt that it's true. Let's start by looking at a state and frame:

Your Emotion: Happy, ring your SmileBell to elicit happiness.

Your Sensations: Comfortable, concentrate on the most relaxed feelings.

Your Intention: Meet someone new and learn how they are similar to you, without expectation. Your Perception: The other person is a happy and friendly person who is similar to you. You can set this by either thinking of someone who you like and admire or remembering the five things you're most proud of about yourself. Your Perception of their Emotion: Happy.

Your Perception of their Sensations: Comfortable.

Your Perception of their Intention: They are here to meet people and learn how those people are similar to themselves.

Your Perception of their Perception: The other person perceives you as a happy and friendly person who is similar to their self.

You Frame or assume the emotion, sensations, intention, and perception the other person has of you. Not exclusively their perception of you. Many people have been told, or conditioned, that they make people uncomfortable or that others aren't interested in meeting them. Or you could be meeting someone you perceive as -- better, more powerful, famous, rich, more attractive, higher up in the company -- this list can go on for a long time. Framing their emotion, sensation, intention, and perception fixes any pre-existing conditioning. Now let's separate the State and Frame:

Your Mental State

Emotion: Happy, ring your SmileBell to elicit happiness.

Sensation: Comfortable, concentrate on the most relaxed feelings.

Intention: Meet someone new and learn how they are similar to you, without expectation.

Perception: The other person is a happy and friendly person who is similar to you. You can set this by either thinking of someone who you like and admire or remembering the five things you're most proud of about yourself.

Their Framed Mental State: Emotion: Happy.

Sensation: Comfortable.

Intention: They are here to meet people and learn how those people are similar to

themselves.

Perception: The other person perceives you as a happy and friendly person who is similar to their self.

You can see your Mental State is very similar to the other person's Frame. You construct one mental image or Frame which applies to both you and the person with whom you will interact. Let's review the key elements of the Frame:

Emotion: Emotion is simply the predominant feeling they have. You want the other person to feel happy, so they desire to continue the interaction. You want the other person to be happy so you apply that to your Frame of their Mental State.

Intention: Their intent will be to find out if you are similar to them and want to continue talking to them, which boils down to curiosity. You are curious about the other person, and they are curious about you. That's why we talk to people, to find out what we have in common. You want the other person to be as curious to learn about you and apply that to your Frame of their Mental State.

Perception: Perception is the other persons' perception of you. Part of framing is deciding what the other person will think of you and what you will think of them as a result of the interaction. The best way to set your perceptions for a stranger is to either think of someone who you like and admire or to remember the five things you're most proud of about yourself. You apply that to your Frame of their Mental State.

Clarification

This is the point where some of our clients need clarification and a quick reality check. Here are three scenarios to put things into perspective.

Scenario one: Imagine being told you should go introduce yourself to someone. You are told, by multiple friends, this person has been informed that you are a wonderful person with a charming personality and they are excited to meet you. You are also told, by multiple friends, they have a wonderful personality and you should be excited to meet them.

Scenario two: Imagine being told you should go introduce yourself to someone. This person is a complete stranger and none of your friends know them. They are just telling you to go introduce yourself.

Scenario three: Imagine being told you should go introduce yourself to someone. You are told, by multiple friends, this person has been informed that you are a terrible person with an off putting personality and they are loathing meeting you and actively avoiding you. You

are also told, by multiple friends, that they are just a terrible person.

Which interaction has the highest chance of success? If the person is a complete stranger in every scenario, which interaction would you approach with the most confidence? You want to believe that every introduction to a stranger is similar to the first scenario. Since we are talking about introducing yourself to strangers you have no reason to believe the frame is untrue.

The practice of Framing and setting your Mental State allows you to control your nonverbal communications. When you meet someone who likes you and wants to get to know you, you will be much more open, honest, and comfortable in your interaction. They will read that body language and understand that you are a likable person who might be similar to themselves. This practice is used before any interaction, be it at a restaurant, a sales call, dating, meeting constituents, talking to people you work with, friends and family, or any interaction with another person.

Mental Preparation

In the verbal communication chapter, you learned a structured introduction using building blocks to make a memorable acronym, CLIFFORD. You also learned about a conversation structure: connect, share likeness, inquire. In nonverbal communication, you have learned what the Mirror Neuron System is, how it works, what a Mental State is, how to apply a Mental State to yourself, and how to construct a Frame for someone else. Now let's look at how you mentally prepare for an interaction:

You decide the Mental State of the other person.

You apply that Mental State to yourself.

You Frame the other individual into that State.

Then you picture or imagine the interaction happening.

Here is a breakdown of each point:

You decide the Mental State of the other person.

Prior to entering into an interaction, you determine the other person's emotions, sensations, intentions, and perceptions. Remember we have a template for this:

Emotion: Happy.

Sensation: Comfortable.

Intention: They are here to meet people and learn how those people are similar to themselves.

Perception: The other person perceives you as a happy and friendly person who is similar to themselves.

You want the other person to feel happy and well-liked. How do you want that person to feel about you? You want them to like you as well and to feel that you are similar to them. A simple question applying the “golden rule” will help determine this: “I want to feel ___ after talking to this person.” You want both yourself and the party you are talking to feel happy, relaxed, comfortable and for the interaction to be a positive one.

You will go into each conversation with a goal of how the other person will feel after meeting you. This will bypass all of your prior conditioning and determine an unbiased outcome to a conversation that hasn’t happened yet. By doing this your verbal communication including your nonverbal tone or vocal communication will line up with that outcome. Your body language or visual communication will also be in line with that outcome. You will behave as if you already know this person, they already know you and you are both comfortable with each other.

Next to smiling knowing the outcome of a conversation before starting it is the most important facet of improved human to human interactions and communication. Once you believe every person you meet is happy to meet you, and because of meeting you, your confidence will grow and you will begin to be conditioned to know that in the vast majority of cases this belief is true.

Before you ever meet someone you will like them and they will like you.

You apply that Mental State to yourself. If you feel happy and like someone you’re talking to, they will read that. Your tone, body language, actions, and reactions will change based on your current Mental State. That state will be read by the other person's mirror neurons, which will cause them to experience your Mental State. This isn’t difficult to see in everyday life. A coworker gets a new car or gets married, everyone congratulates them and smiles. Your parent, teacher, or boss gets angry; people have to meet and boom negative emotions spread. You put yourself into the state you want the person you are talking to have during the conversation. Again remember we have a template for this:

Your Mental State

Emotion: Happy, ring your SmileBell to elicit happiness.

Sensations: Comfortable, concentrate on the most relaxed feelings.

Intention: Meet someone new and learn how they are similar to you, without expectation.

Perception: The other person is a happy and friendly person who is similar to you. You can set this by either thinking of someone who you like and admire or remembering the five things you're most proud of about yourself.

You Frame the other individual into that Mental State. A part of the Mental State you build will include the Frame of the other person. You will perceive the Mental State you would like the other person to achieve from the conversation, you must tell yourself that the other person is already in that Mental State. You must also believe yourself. When approaching strangers, you have no reason to believe they are not in that Mental State. Your Frame will determine a lot of your behavior towards them. Once again, your tone, body language, actions, and reactions will change based on your perception of the other person's Mental State. Once again refer to our template:

Your Emotion: Happy, ring your SmileBell to elicit happiness.

Your Sensations: Comfortable, concentrate on the most relaxed feelings.

Your Intention: Meet someone new and learn how they are similar to you, without expectation. Your Perception: The other person is a happy and friendly person who is similar to you. You can set this by either thinking of someone who you like and admire or remembering the five things you're most proud of about yourself. Your Perception of their Emotion: Happy.

Your Perception of their Sensations: Comfortable.

Your Perception of their Intention: They are here to meet people and learn how those people are similar to themselves.

Your Perception of their Perception: The other person perceives you as a happy and friendly person who is similar to their self.

You picture or imagine the interaction happening. You always walk through an interaction or introduction in your mind before it happens. Not the entire conversation, first conversations can last hours, just the interaction's start and end state. This ensures you clearly Frame the other person while having a proper Mental State. The old Friend and The new Friend (former acquaintance)

Wrapping Up

Why do you need to do all this mental preparation when meeting someone? Operant conditioning, mixed with some classical conditioning. You are, dear Reader, filled with thoughts, perceptions, doubts, fears, and desires. You perceive the world through an experiential lense. You have a Frame for yourself, for people you know, and for strangers. A lot of what you build into your Frame for strangers has nothing to do with reality or the strangers' perceptions. Much of what you build into your Frame for people you know has nothing to do with reality or their perceptions.

All of this mental preparation bypasses your prior conditioning, learning, and knowledge. The aim of intentionally setting your Mental State and Framing is so you can nonverbally communicate without bias or judgment, without fear or doubt, without expectation or intention.

A crucial point regarding framing: as you know, people run from fear with twice the effort they run toward happiness. Using our above examples makes the person who is angry in a stronger state than the happiness state you've framed. You must be able to Frame yourself and others stronger than their current Mental State or the frame will fail.

Framing can be tested and practiced until you build up more control over your Mental State, which will strengthen your ability to Frame other's States. Just like baseball players practice playing baseball to get better, you will practice Framing to get better. If you Frame yourself and another person as happy and then spend time with them, they will become happier. This is called transference.

CHAPTER 8

Reframing

This book is not only about meeting strangers. The same tools change existing relationships: what you think about other people, and what they think about you. The strongest frame wins. The persistent frame overcomes. Framing and reframing are how that change happens.

Framing is when you believe something without knowing it.

Reframing is when you believe something you assume is different.

Advanced framing (reframing) is when you believe something in spite of believing something else.

Expert framing (reframing) is when you believe something in spite of knowing something else. If you picked this book up to get through social anxiety or to get better at meeting people, you do not need advanced or expert framing. That work lives in other courses and texts. What follows is a simple overview so the language is consistent. The rest of this chapter stays on the body — the part of the frame other people can actually see.

Reframing

In chapter 6 we covered Mental States and Framing. A more advanced form of Framing is Reframing. Framing is when you believe something without knowing it. Which is why it can be easy to Frame a complete stranger. It is much easier to believe something when you don't have any knowledge of that thing. Reframing is when you believe something despite a contrary assumption.

Advanced Reframing is when you believe something despite believing or having believed something else.

“We question all of our beliefs, except for the ones we really believe in, and those we never think to question” ~ Orson Scott Card

If “... can't ...” or “...impossible...” just rolled through your thoughts, you most certainly can. Lewis Carroll, Arthur C Clarke, Elon Musk, Alexander Graham Bell and thousands of others have advice for you. Here are three selected pieces of advice:

Alice "There's no use trying; one can't believe impossible things." The Queen: "I daresay you haven't had much practice. When I was younger, I always did it for half an hour a day. Why sometimes I've believed as many as six impossible things before breakfast." ~Alice In Wonderland by Lewis Carroll

Clarke's Second Law: The only way of discovering the limits of the possible is to venture a little way past them into the impossible. ~ Arthur C. Clarke "Hazards of Prophecy: The Failure of Imagination" Profiles of the Future 1962

Elon Musk could not build a reusable rocket to fly to the ISS and, eventually, Mars. It was impossible. Even more, Elon didn't know anything about rockets! Yet in 2020, a reusable rocket flew Bob and Doug to the ISS. Elon believed the impossible. So can you.

To reiterate, advanced reframing is when you believe something despite believing something else. If "... can't ..." or "...impossible..." just rolled through your thoughts, you most certainly can. People change their beliefs all the time. Changing a belief simply requires believing something despite currently believing something else. A belief is simply a thought that you keep thinking. If you start and continue thinking something else, you will begin to believe differently.

Advanced reframing is bypassing your judgment and changing your conditioned perception. When you Reframe, you are changing your perception. Here are some examples:

What you perceive about yourself: "I'm brilliant." You can change what you think about yourself through reframing.

What you perceive about someone else: "They are brilliant." You can change what you think about another person through reframing.

There are several misconceptions or misperceptions which branch from these:

What someone else thinks about you: "They think I'm brilliant." You cannot directly change what another thinks about you without changing what you think about yourself and the other person. You also cannot directly know what someone else thinks about you. Because you cannot know what someone thinks about you or how they perceive you, this perception is what you think someone else perceives about you. Tying up this loose end, what you perceive someone else perceives about you is simply something you perceive about someone else. You can change your belief and your perception.

What someone else perceives you think about yourself: “They think I think I’m brilliant.” You have the perception; you can change it. We split this into your perceptions about others (Reframing) and your perceptions about yourself (Self Reframing).

Reframing Others

What you say when they aren’t around is more important than what you say when they are.

Reframing is when you believe something despite believing something else.

If you believe someone dislikes you, the way to reframe them is to start believing they like you. Believe something despite believing something else. Over time your belief will change. Over multiple interactions, the other person's Mirror Neuron System will pick up on this change.

The same steps outlined in Self Reframing below can be used to Reframe your perceptions of someone else. With practice, you will change your Mental State and Frames with ease simply by changing your predominant thoughts.

To reiterate a crucial point regarding framing: When you Reframe someone else you are changing your own opinion. In some cases people do believe something about you and it’s not just your own self-perception or judgement. In these rare cases you must be able to Frame yourself and others stronger than their current Mental State or the Frame will fail and Transference will not occur. If someone believes the earth is flat and you want to convince them it isn’t you will have to believe the earth is round with more intensity than their five closest associates believe it is flat.

Self Reframing

Reframing is when you believe something despite believing something else. Reframing is not when you believe something despite the truth.

Many people tell you things and, through operant conditioning, you begin to believe those things. One of the people telling you things is you. To reframe yourself you need to discard what you are currently telling yourself or what you currently believe. If you are unable to simply change your Mental State and, therefore, your perception about yourself, you can use reframing.

“Why not just ask people and use outside feedback?”

It is easy to find one-hundred people who agree with you or one-hundred who disagree. Since we know people like people who are similar to themselves, you are more likely to find people who agree with the good and disagree with the bad. There are bodies of research regarding confirmation bias, cognitive dissonance, and the dunning-kruger effect. Generally, your brain won't believe their true opinion because you need to be the one thinking a specific thought.

Reframing yourself is accomplished through changing your belief. There are several steps; each will have a compounding effect. If you do step one through five daily it will be more effective than step one through four daily. Reframing yourself is just telling your subconscious to change your perception. Often telling yourself filters through your critical faculty or perception and is discarded so you need to bypass your critical faculty. A belief is a thought that you keep thinking, these steps replace your current thought with a new one.

Tell yourself, "I am [the thing you want to believe]." If applicable, add "the people I meet [tell me or confirm] [belief] is true." Write this phrase down every night before you go to bed and every morning after waking up.

Read it aloud in the mirror to yourself every morning and every night.

Make it the first thing you say to yourself in the morning and the last thing you say to yourself at night. As soon as you wake up and while you are falling asleep.

Carry the morning copy in your wallet, purse, or pocket to see it or feel it every time you access that.

Put it on a sticky note or plaque, your phone lock screen, your computer, so that you see it and read it continually.

Associate this statement with a color and symbol and plaster everything you look at with that symbol drawn on or in that color.

Jim Carrey wrote himself a ten-million-dollar check in 1985. The memo read "for acting services rendered." The check was dated ten years in the future and he carried this check in his wallet for ten years. Jim reframed his future so he could cash the check.

Reframing yourself uses active language. "The grass is green." Not future language "I will believe the grass is green." Your subconscious will work to line up reality with what it's being fed.

Some common generic examples:

Smoking: "I am a nonsmoker. The smell of smoke disgusts me, and I cannot bear the taste associated with smoking."

Names: “I am great at remembering names and faces. The people I meet are always impressed that I can remember their names and faces.”

Happiness: “I am a happy person. People often tell me how happy they are to see me and ask if something wonderful just happened. I smile and laugh a lot.”

Social Anxiety: “I enjoy talking to people and human interaction. The people I interact with enjoy our conversations. I’m always happy to meet new people.”

Just make and write one of these statements down. Every day, every night. Read it aloud in the mirror every morning and every night. Make it the first thing you say to yourself in the morning when waking up, make it the last thing your brain hears before falling asleep. Write it down on a piece of paper and then draw a colored symbol to associate with it. A red circle is enough. And then put a red circle on everything you own, everything you see, put a red circle in the signature of your email, get T-shirts for your friends to wear and get them in on it making their own change statements. Just plaster it everywhere. It’ll change your life.

If your belief is more of a goal, you will use a portion of the SMART goals format. Specific, Measurable, Attainable, Relative, Time Based. The same way Jim Carrey did. Your brain can only fill in so many gaps.

Not Specific: “I run a successful real estate investment firm.” Specific: “I run a successful real estate investment firm with over a dozen multi-family units and fifty-thousand dollars a month in net income.”

You will, of course, become focused on achieving your goal at the expense of anything in life for which you do not put forth as much self-talk.

Expert Reframing

Expert reframing is a topic for another text. To answer the most asked question by beta readers and reviewers:

“How much can you reframe? Can you reframe facts?”

Facts are your perception of your reality and yes, reframing reality is when you believe something despite knowing something else. Flat earthers have reframed reality and transferred that frame to others.

“What the eyes see, and the ears hear, the mind believes” ~Houdini.

What do Buddhist monks, pathological liars, and hypnotists have in common? They each know of the plasticity of reality. What you think of as reality is merely processing the input from the five senses in the mind. You may think of reality as fact, for example:

The grass is green.

The grass is green because you have visual input, you know the color green, and you associate a specific wavelength of the visible electromagnetic spectrum as “green.”

Input: Sense of sight.

Fact: Specific wavelength of the visible electromagnetic spectrum.

Perception: Green.

You cannot change your input stimuli or facts. You can change your perception, or as a hypnotist, change others’ perceptions; green can be red. The fact remains the same, the input remains the same; only your perception changes. Reality is your perception of your senses; by changing your perception, you effectively change your reality.

Experts can Reframe themselves instantly. Things as ridiculous as Reframing themselves as wearing a full clown outfit, big shoes, full makeup, and a big red nose. When you Reframe over a longer period, your brain has two choices; it can begin taking actions to make the frame real or it can take actions to negate the Frame. When facts disagree with the Frame, your brain will first try to make the Frame real. If the Frame is weak or cannot be made true, it will try to negate the Frame and Reframe your perception to match reality.

Some examples: Jim Carrey framed himself as being a successful multimillion-dollar actor. His brain worked, and he took action to make that frame a reality.

Chronic pain can be reframed as it is simply a sensory perception that can be changed. Your height, while it may change naturally, is a fact. If you reframe your height you’ll have the interesting effect of ducking under doors for no reason or standing on ladders for things you can reach. Your brain will try to negate the frame, or you’ll be a loon.

Expert Reframing happens accidentally more than intentionally in the world today. You will tend to believe what the five people closest to you believe regardless of fact or truth. Once again there are bodies of research regarding confirmation bias, cognitive dissonance, and the dunning-kruger effect all of which are methods of you being Reframed by others.

Communication Enhancements

Getting into the conversation

Time Constraints

Time constraints are used by people who talk for a living — sales, interviews, investigations, and anyone trained to start a conversation on purpose. The job is the same in every field: lower the threat of “this person might never leave.” A time constraint reduces the perceived threat humans pose to each other and builds comfort in the person you are speaking with. There are true time constraints, false time constraints, and true-ish ones. If someone does not fall into “I can handle this right now,” they become a hurdle to get around. We have a natural aversion to difficulty and an attraction to ease.

Tell someone there is an end in sight to talking to you. The conversation becomes a task with a finish line instead of an obstacle with no clock. People trained in communication know how to get out of a conversation, so they are not afraid to enter one. Most people are not trained. They avoid getting into conversations because they cannot see the exit. That is what time constraints are for. “I’ve only got a minute.” “I’m meeting some friends, but—” “I’ve got a meeting in a minute.” True: you actually have to go.

False: you do not, and you said it to lower the threat.

True-ish: your friends are somewhere with no fixed time. You can leave. You might not. If you aren’t performing a criminal investigation, stick to true or true-ish. A false clock is a lie. The relationship, whatever it is, will sit on that lie, and that is not a solid foundation. Truth is the way to go. Robin Dreeke, former FBI behavioral analysis, puts this first in his rapport work. The first step in developing rapport is letting the other person know there is an end in sight, and it is close. “I’m meeting my wife in a few minutes. But I’m curious about the book you are reading...” “I have to get to a meeting. I have a quick question...” They relax. The talk often has more energy because it is not an open-ended capture.

This is permission to start. If the conversation is good, they will extend it. If it is not, you already gave them the door.

Enthusiasm

Frank Bettger’s point was simple: enthusiasm is not a personality type. You put it on before the conversation, then you show real interest once you are in it.

Prepare with enthusiasm. Decide the person is worth meeting and the talk is worth having

before you walk up. If you prepare flat, you arrive flat.

Then show interest. A lot of interest. Ask, lean in, let them talk. People feel the difference between polite attention and actual interest, and they stay for the second kind.

Fake-bright cheerleading is not the point. State first, then genuine curiosity.

Maintaining Relationships

Compliment behind their backs

You learned the basics of introducing yourself with a smile and compliment in the last chapter. You also learned the basics of instant observation. Did you know you can give compliments more often than just when you meet someone? People will run from insults with twice the effort they will run toward compliments.

Compliment friends, family, strangers. Compliment people “behind their back.” Traditionally the phrase is associated with those who would attack from behind it is now applied more to words than physical attacks. If you can “attack” someone with words behind their back, you can most assuredly compliment them in the same manner. They won’t see it coming. For example “gosh Lisa always finds the best shoes!” or even just thinking that to yourself. Complimenting someone without them knowing will lead to you feeling more positive about that person which will make your interactions with them more positive.

The 5 Friends

Regression/progression to the mean. You drift toward the five people you spend the most time with — mood, language, ambition, what counts as normal. Not a conversation opener. An environment rule. If those five are complainers, you will talk like a complainer. If they are high-state, you get pulled up. This belongs with Mental State / anchors, not with pickup framing.

Maintaining the Conversation

Elicitation

Much of the nonfactual information you convey will be in the form of communicating something you have or will experience. Something you have experienced would be, “I went to the grocery store.” Something you will experience would be, “I am going to the grocery store.” You convey experiences by telling a story. Stories may seem better suited for the

book's verbal communication portion, and the verbal form of stories are. When you share an experience you want to elicit emotions and imagery in the other person. Instead of telling a story you want to share the experience which involves eliciting emotions and activating mirror neurons.

You may be wondering why something so simple as going to the grocery store is used as an example. Most award-winning stories in literary or film form have much more in-depth plotlines and content. Working with very mundane subjects helps you to learn more effective and robust storytelling skills. Then when you have a truly memorable experience and apply these same techniques those shared experiences will be even stronger. Someone who is fantastic at sharing an epic tale of skydiving will lack the skills of someone who is able to share an epic tale of going to the grocery store.

When you tell a story, you use words to describe the sensations, the emotions, and the likeness of your experience to the other person. When you tell a story with these elements, you will elicit emotions and experiences in the other person. The person you are talking to will experience the same emotions and senses as you through their imagination and mirror neurons. Let's walk through the mundane statement "I went to the grocery store" and build it into more of a shared experience.

The first thing you do when telling a story is to give the experience some context. What were you doing before you went to the grocery store? How did you get to the grocery store? What happened while you were there? Here is an example with some context added:

"Yesterday, I was reading a book; then I had to go to the grocery store to pick up bananas for my kid. After driving there and getting bananas, the self-checkout broke, and then the next self-checkout broke. It was a nightmare."

The above version is slightly better than "I went to the grocery store," and you can expand the story by thinking about each part's details. What kind of book? Why did you have to get bananas? What types of senses did you experience sights, sounds, smells, feelings, tastes?

"So yesterday I was reading a sci-fi book. When my kid came in and reminded me we needed bananas for tomorrow. So anyway, I drove to the store, which involved sweating until the air conditioning caught up. After I got the bananas and got to the self-checkout, the thing made this loud beep flashed really bright on the screen and then just went out of order. So I went to the next one, and the same thing happened! It was like that nightmare I had. Sigh, so that was my banana experience."

You continue expanding upon the various details of the story and adding more sensory experiences and emotions. You also make your story as relatable to the other person as possible. Remember we share likeness often. If you are speaking to someone you know, there are various things you will have in common. If you are chatting with a stranger, you will integrate what you learned from CLIFFORD and any follow-up conversation. Constructing that information into our example grocery store story now looks like this:

“So yesterday I was reading a fantastic sci-fi book, the one you told me about, I love it, I was completely into this book and felt like I was on the ship when my kid came in and reminded me we needed bananas for tomorrow. I jumped. I was so startled at the sound, and it pulled me right out of the book. You know that feeling of shock you get when you feel like you just jumped out of one reality into another? Anyway, I drove to the store, which involved sweating until the air conditioning caught up, so I’m worried that I will be all sweaty and smelly when I get to the store. After I got the bananas and got to the self-checkout, the thing made this loud beep flashed really bright on the screen and then just went out of order. So I went to the next one, and the same thing happened! At that point, I’m just standing there staring at this machine when a staff member comes up and asks if they can help. I shared that weird nightmare I had where all the self-checkouts broke one after another. Then the cashiers started closing their lanes as soon as I got to them. We had a good laugh, and they helped me get checked out. Luckily I left the car running, so the ride home was nice and cool. From spaceship to nightmare to laughing about that ridiculous dream. So that was my night, how was yours?”

The final version of your trip to the grocery store is a one-minute to two-minute story, including all of the elements you need to elicit an experience in the other person. You can add to or remove from the story by merely adding or removing sensory, emotional, or relatable material.

Sensations: Sight, sound, touch, taste, and smell using as many descriptors of what you experienced will help someone feel or more genuinely experience your story.

Emotions: What emotions did you feel and what caused you to feel them.

Likeness: Whenever possible, include things that are related to the other person. Allow them to experience some of themselves in your story. You may have heard the phrase people like people who are similar to themselves.

Highlight the Happiness

What if you could highlight the happy moments to make them have more impact on yourself and the other person? You've already learned how communicating with emotions, senses, and relatable material helps to create a vastly heightened experience when interacting with someone. Storytelling allows you to create a shared experience between you and another person or group. Highlight The Happiness is a technique which uses the SmileBell you created to enhance the positive emotions felt by your conversation partner.

You know from Chapter one you can elicit genuine happiness, and a genuine smile, in yourself on command using a touch. You may also remember from Chapter one; elicitation can use any of the five senses. Highlighting happiness is performed exactly as it sounds; you perform an action whenever you or your conversation partner share something positive, an emotion, laughter, or a smile.

During the conversation anytime you or the other person share a positive emotion, smile, or laugh, ring your SmileBell. Reach up with your dominant hand and press with two fingers just below your collarbone. This action will set and ring your SmileBell and visually highlight the happy moments for the person you are talking to. You have a touch-based SmileBell; they have a sight-based SmileBell. Each time there is happiness in the interaction, ring the bell.

That's it, throughout a more extended conversation, you can end up ringing this bi-directional SmileBell bell dozens of times. From Chapter one:

You can also repeatedly ring your SmileBell to enhance your current emotional state. Each time you ring your SmileBell, you will improve the effect. During a conversation, you can ring your SmileBell to reinforce the emotion.

Meaning this technique will enhance your enjoyment, as well as your conversation partners enjoyment, of the conversation through the cumulative effect.

A question we are often asked when teaching this technique is "what if the other person notices or asks why I'm doing that?" The answer is simple, explain it to them and teach them how to do it. Somewhere between zero and two percent of people will ask why you are waving your hand in front of your face, touching your nose, touching your left or right side repeatedly or whatever action you use for your personal SmileBell. It is very rare and it's a great experience to be able to teach someone else! To be clear, if someone asks you, you teach them the SmileBell technique and the Highlight The Happiness technique, then go on with your conversation continuing to use it.

Your Body in the Room

Using Body Talk

When you use framing and Mental States, your body language will align with your mood and intention to convey your meaning. As you start meeting more people and building confidence you will start occupying more physical and emotional space. You can read any of the numerous studies on how taking a more dominant body position will boost your confidence. You could read the research on how specific actions and gestures are perceived or you could ask yourself a simple question. When you see people talking, are you more likely to notice someone physically taking more space or taking less space?

When you see someone sitting down with their legs up on a chair, and their arms draped over the back of another chair, they take the space of more than one individual. When you see someone sitting who has their arms crossed and feet close to their body hunched down, they take less space than one individual. You can likely recall seeing this from memory or just watch for it. When you are more relaxed and more confident, you will take up more space. The alternative is also valid; as you take up more space, your comfort and confidence will improve.

Similarly, the amount of space your body uses when talking and the number of movements you make will have the same effect. Talk with your whole body. If you are telling a story and, at some point, you are jumping, physically jump. If the story contains “...reached up and grabbed...” reach up and grab at the air. When you are generally more expressive with your body and face, you take up more physical space. You will be more memorable and more likable, and you communicate much more meaning when speaking. You also want to be open and inviting with your body talk.

Being more Approachable

Approachability or openness relates to others’ perceptions of you both before and during an interaction. Being open means, you are nonverbally showing an intent to have or continue a conversation.

You do not put objects between yourself and the other person. When you place an item between yourself and another person, it is a barricade. Nonverbally this communicates you are in some way trying to block or separate yourself from the other person. You are trying to protect yourself from them nonverbally. Do not put notebooks, drinks, purses, computers on the front of your body. The feet point objects block, it’s communicated.

When greeting people entering a room, being open involves standing in front of the traditional barriers. If there is a podium or table, you stand in front of it. You face each entrant to greet them with no barriers. Facing people without barriers.

When you are generally out at a social place, stand in a busy place with an open posture. Usually, a door, a drinks station, or a similar place where people will be walking by or stopping.

Using Touch

The act of touching is a form of communication and has a strange accelerating effect on Framing. You are more likely to smile when someone genuinely happy and laughing talks to you and touches you than just from their talking. Extroverts and great communicators frequently use touch when it's invited and appropriate. You can see this most clearly when an extrovert walks into a room, shakes everyone's hands, places a hand on shoulders when speaking, and hugs everyone.

Previous generations practiced universal touch; today, we know that touch should be invited and not a default. As a great communicator, you will reciprocate or ask before using touch to avoid any sticky legal situations or uncomfortable misunderstandings.

In professional situations you would extend your right hand for a handshake while in more personal situations you would reach out your arms for a hug. The intermediate is a gesture called "handshake or hug" which is an open gesture where you reach out your right hand for a handshake and stretch your left for a hug. The other person chooses their preference. Body language determines if the left-hand drops or pats them on the shoulder.

Voice

The vast majority of your tonality will be corrected through framing, as discussed previously. The remaining bit will improve by adjusting your pitch, tempo, and volume. Proper voice training and coaching is beyond the scope of this work. Below is a summary and some simple actions you can take.

Pitch: Amongst the vast advice given for your pitch exist many humming exercises and many disagreeing theories. The simplest method is to hum higher and lower pitch and lower or raise your typical speaking pitch until your voice does not change when plugging your nose. You should use a lot more breath when speaking this way, which will naturally slow your speed.

Speed: For the vast majority of people talk slower. Your range is 120 words per minute, up to 160 words per minute. Lower rates are generally better when speaking in groups or on camera. Somewhere in the middle of the range is a conversational rate. The two methods to determine your speech rate are: Ask people you talk to if you speak too fast or slow. Record yourself speaking a known number of words, with your phone or a cheap audio recorder, time it, and find your rate. Once you know your rate, simply talk faster or slower and record yourself daily until you reach the preferred range.

Volume: For the vast majority of people talk louder. The average conversational volume is around 60 decibels. The two methods to determine your speech volume are: Ask people you speak to if you talk too loud or soft. Speak the same text you used in the last exercise into a decibel meter or phone app. Once you know your volume, simply talk louder or softer and record yourself daily until you reach the preferred range.

For a Deeper Dive on this topic read: *It's The Way You Say It* by Carol A Fleming, Ph.D.

Posture

Your physical posture will communicate a lot about you to other people. Posture is a sign of confidence as you interact with more people; your personality will grow and have more presence. You should match your posture, so when you walk into a room, the first things you communicate to people is good posture and a vibe of happiness. Some parts of posture are also different types of body positioning.

How do you know if you have good or bad posture, and how do you test it or fix it? Simple. You find a wall and another person. Stand with your back against the wall, heels against the wall, push your shoulders back until they touch; this will raise your chest. The bit you may need help with, pull your head back while keeping your chin straight until the back of your head touches the wall or have your friend gently push your chin back. If you feel pain, you will have to work towards this and stretch out your muscles. Setting your SmileBell while maintaining this correct posture will allow you to snap yourself into the proper posture. Ensure you start with a correct posture or you will snap yourself into an injury.

Deeper Dive: Call a physical therapist that does free consultations and ask if they can correct your posture. Most will be able to prescribe exercise and perform simple tests to strengthen and correct your posture.

Physical Appearance

It turns out in research study after research study that people who others perceive as looking “more admirable” have better outcomes in life. The statement repeated throughout this book could be corrected to say people like people who are similar to themselves and even more like people they perceive as better than themselves. These outcomes include some strange things like earning more in civil settlements and lower sentencing time in criminal trials. As well as a host of other improved outcomes where all other things are equal, people like people more when they see others as better than themselves. Though these things that society defines as making a person “more admirable” are not logical in any way, outside of sound medical advice, it would be dishonest to say that they don’t exist.

You should consider some things when you move into group settings; those are the five senses starting with sight. The easiest way to be a more significant presence than the rest of the room is with your clothing. For a group that you will lead, your clothing should either be on par with those in each group or a step dressier. Of course, your clothing should fit correctly. Get fitted or measured to get appropriately fitting clothing. It will make a world of difference for a minor effort.

You’ve already reviewed posture, voice, touch, and body talk, which will give you a more prominent physical presence. You are reading the wrong book if your taste is a concern while you meet a group of individuals. As for smell; the more neutral your scent, the better. Some people will have allergies, others will like and dislike various colognes and perfumes.

On the statistically better outcomes of those who fit your cultures, “more admirable” looks. It’s a topic far beyond the scope of this book. There is an argument to be made that if you are ok with who you are and your doctor isn’t breathing down your neck to change something, then you are doing great. The other side of the argument is that if changing something will result in statistically better outcomes in life and there is no detriment to making the change, you should change it. You can move in a direction that will be perceived more positively by other members of society. Regardless, you can still elicit happiness in yourself and others. There are plenty of “more admirable” looking introverts in the world who lack the self-confidence or experience to go out and talk to people.

Just work on deprogramming your own biases towards others regardless of the path you take.

PART III

Meeting Individuals

CHAPTER 10

Review and Putting It All Together

Below is our current human interaction guide with the associated chapters listed. If any part of this isn't clear or you don't understand any portion, go back and re-read the associated chapter as we are going to build this into its final structure for use in the remainder of the book.

Make eye contact then smile (Chapter 1)

Decide the Mental State of the other person. (Chapter 6) Apply that Mental State to yourself. (Chapter 6) Frame (Chapter 6) or Reframe (Chapter 8) the other individual into that State.

Picture or imagine the interaction happening. (Chapter 6)

Point your body toward the individual (Chapter 5) slightly raise your eyebrows (Chapter 1) and CLIFFORD (Chapter 3)

There is no Acronym or other system to memorize this interaction guide. The only acronym you will need to know is CLIFFORD. Making eye contact and smiling will be an involuntary habit. If smiling and making eye contact is not already a habit you would benefit from completing the "Smile At A Stranger" activity back in chapter one. Eye contact and smiling should not require intentional thought, you should practice the Smile at a stranger activity until this becomes a habit. Once the habit forms you will automatically make eye contact and smile at everyone.

CLIFFORD is the foundation of approach, introduction, and conversation. Memorize it and practice it until you can run through it with a stranger while distracted. Thousands of questions exist within the CLIFFORD structure with only a few dozen listed within this book. Each is a broad category and the acronym is simply your guide for how to follow that structure and find a spark which leads into longer conversations. The Connect, share Likeness, then Inquire conversation format which is built into the acronym provides never ending conversation.

Pointing your body towards the individual is a natural instinct as you will need to approach the person or they will need to approach you. When either of these happen you will already be positioned towards them or will turn to greet them.

Mental preparation which consists of Mental States, Framing, and imagining the conversation happening is where you will be focusing all of your attention. The moment you decide you will be introducing yourself to people, be it at a bar, school, work, networking event, you should be setting your Mental State and the other person's Frame from the moment eye contact happens. Only briefly pausing to imagine the interaction happening before it does.

Putting it all together

Let's take a look at the full structured guide to human interaction, then a description, then a breakdown of each step.

Make eye contact then smile.

Decide the ending Mental State of the other person.

Apply that Mental State to yourself.

Frame the other individual into that State.

Picture or imagine the interaction happening.

Point your body and feet toward the individual, mirror, slightly raise your eyebrows, and CLIFFORD.

You are somewhere where there are also other people. You see someone who looks like they might be interesting to talk to, someone introduces you, you are working and a customer approaches, or you are just practicing and found a person. You make eye contact with them and they with you. You smile at them. You determine their ending Mental State, put yourself into that State, Frame them in that Mental State in your mind. Remove or walk around any barriers between you and the other person. Point your body and feet at that person because you want to get to know them better, not run away. Naturally slightly raise your eyebrows like a knight raising the helmet's face shield or a gentleman tipping his hat. Then finally mirror their outward stance slightly and CLIFFORD.

The interaction starts when you make bidirectional eye contact. You look at them and they look back at you. You immediately smile and begin to set your Mental State to include their Frame. You only get five seconds, or your mind will choose a fight, flight, or freeze instinct. Imagining the interaction after or during setting your Mental State may take a moment or seconds. In under five seconds you will be standing facing the person and begin your CLIFFORD structured introduction. Now let's look at the details of the system point by point.

Make eye contact then smile. You make eye contact with them and they with you; this is a two-way deal as there are two parties. You smile at them after eye contact is made to set the very first impression and the tone of the interaction. This is a habitual and automatic behavior. Every person you see you should make eye contact and smile when they return eye contact. This is a genuine smile created by ringing your SmileBell.

Decide the ending Mental State of the other person. This is slightly different wording than the version in Chapter 6 as it is the version used once you overcome social anxiety. Prior to entering into an interaction, you determine what the other persons' emotions, sensations, intentions, and perceptions will be after the conversation. If you are nervous or anxious about what a person will think when you approach them you use the current mental state of the person. If you have practiced the content in the previous chapters you are ready for more advanced interactions and you would use the other persons' ending mental state.

This slight change allows you to introduce something you know into the conversation. Something you know will happen is not an intention or an expectation. Let's use a salesperson as an example. If you know the person you are talking to is a customer, you will simply help them choose the right product, payments, and features without attempting to convince them to buy something. That will provide comfort and confidence for both parties and as there is no expectation there is no pressure or rejection involved on either side.

Our template modified for an ending state: Emotion: Happy to have met you.

Sensation: Comfortable and relaxed around you. Intention: Whatever your goal of the conversation is. For practicing and with our clients this line reads: "To exchange contact information or set a follow-up appointment so we they continue our discussion" Perception: The other person perceives you as a happy and friendly person who is similar to themself.

You want the other person to feel happy and well-liked. How do you want that person to feel about you? You want them to like you as well and to feel that you are similar to them. A simple question applying the "golden rule" will help determine this: "I want to feel ___ after talking to this person." You want both yourself and the party you are talking to feel happy, relaxed, comfortable and for the interaction to be a positive one.

Go into each conversation with a goal of how the other person will feel after meeting you. This will bypass all of your prior conditioning and determine an unbiased outcome to a conversation that hasn't happened yet. By doing this your verbal communication including your nonverbal tone or vocal communication will line up with that outcome. Your body language or visual communication will also be in line with that outcome. You will behave as if you already know this person, they already know you and you are both comfortable with each other.

Next to smiling and removing expectation, knowing the outcome of a conversation before starting it is the most important facet of improved human to human interactions and communication. Once you believe every person you meet is happy to meet you, and because of meeting you, your confidence will grow and you will begin to be conditioned to know that in the vast majority of cases this belief is true.

Before you ever meet someone you will like them and they will like you.

Apply that Mental State to yourself. If you feel happy and like someone you're talking to, they will read that. Your tone, body language, actions, and reactions will change based on your current Mental State. That state will be read by the other person's mirror neurons, which will cause them to experience your Mental State. This isn't difficult to see in everyday life. A coworker gets a new car or gets married, everyone congratulates them and smiles. Your parents, teacher, or boss gets angry; people have to interact with them and boom negative emotions spread. You put yourself into the state you want the person you are talking to have after meeting or interacting with you. Again remember we have a template for this:

Your Mental State

Emotion: Happy, ring your SmileBell to elicit happiness.

Sensations: Comfortable, concentrate on the most relaxed feelings.

Intention: To bring them happiness and find out how you can assist them or to meet someone new and learn how they are similar to you, without expectation. Perception: The other person is a happy and friendly person who is similar to you. You can set this by either thinking of someone who you like and admire or remembering the five things you're most proud of about yourself.

Frame or Reframe the other individual into that Mental State. A part of the Mental State you build will include the Frame of the other person. You will perceive the Mental State you would like the other person to achieve from the conversation, you must tell yourself that the other person is already in that Mental State. You must also believe yourself. When approaching strangers, you have no reason to believe they are not in that Mental State. When Reframing refer to Chapter 8 for guidance. Your Frame will determine your behavior towards them. Once again, your tone, body language, actions, and reactions will change based on your perception of the other person's Mental State. Your Mental State and Frame:

Emotion: Happy, ring your SmileBell to elicit happiness.

Sensations: Comfortable, concentrate on the most relaxed feelings.

Intention: To bring them happiness and find out how you can assist them or to meet someone new and learn how they are similar to you, without expectation. Perception: The

other person is a happy and friendly person who is similar to you. You can set this by either thinking of someone who you like and admire or remembering the five things you're most proud of about yourself. They are: Happy to have met you.

Your Perception of their Sensation: Comfortable and relaxed around you. Your Perception of their Intention: Whatever your goal of the conversation is. For practicing and with our clients this line reads: "To exchange contact information or set a follow-up appointment so we can continue our discussion" Your Perception of their Perception: The other person perceives you as a happy and friendly person who is similar to themselves.

Picture or imagine the interaction happening. You always walk through an interaction or introduction in your mind before it happens. Not the entire conversation, first conversations can last hours, just the interaction's start and end state. This ensures you clearly Frame the other person while having a proper Mental State.

Why do you need to imagine the interaction before it happens? Imagining an action before taking it is another little brain shortcut. The first time you do something is far more complicated than the second, third, and ten-thousandth. By performing a task in your mind before performing it in reality, your real attempt will be your second attempt. This shortcut works for all sorts of situations in life and is especially useful if you get nervous around people.

You point your body and feet toward the individual You are going to communicate verbally and nonverbally your body is a billboard which displays your Mental State and Frame. You want to point that billboard towards them with no obstacles between their eyes and the billboard that is your body. To achieve your communication's maximum effectiveness, you need to point your body at the person, so you share the full visible and audible field.

Your feet point to where you want to go or where you want to be. You want to be involved in a conversation with the person, so that is where your feet point. Since you either walked up to the person or turned towards them your body and feet will already automatically and habitually be facing them. Are their feet pointing towards you?

Mirror

Mirroring is exactly what it sounds like. You want to approach an interaction with a similar outward posture as the other person; therefore, you will want to be mirroring their external behavior when you introduce yourself. Their stance may not match up to your emotional state, which is fine as your body will naturally adjust during the conversation. This is why you stand up to greet someone who walks up to you or gesture to a chair so you can sit by a person who is sitting.

Slightly raise your eyebrows Show a gesture and vulnerability just as raising the face shields or tipping of the top hat accomplished. When you start delivering a complement or observation verbally while smiling your eyebrows will naturally, slightly raise.

And Finally CLIFFORD

With practice your structured introduction becomes Mental Preparation, imaging the interaction happening before it does, and CLIFFORD. Three simple steps. You start with a compliment or observation. You introduce yourself. You Inquire about something From, Family, Occupation, Recreation, Dreams.

Final Review

The entire structured introduction works for more than meeting strangers. When you go to work or handle a customer or salesperson you can use the entire structured introduction for your conversation.

Make eye contact then smile.

Decide the ending Mental State of the other person.

Apply that Mental State to yourself.

Frame the other individual into that State.

Picture or imagine the interaction happening.

Point your body and feet toward the individual, mirror, slightly raise your eyebrows, and CLIFFORD. For an acquaintance or co-worker you will likely use a compliment or observation from your instant observation. You may also use the Small Talk format of “Good morning, Name, how are you today?”

Now you have a system for human interaction. When do you use it? Always. During every interaction. Grabbing some coffee creamer from the local pharmacy? The cashier is likely wearing a nametag. Eye contact, smile, mental preparation, point your billboard, mirror, “Hey, Quinn, How’s work today?” Talking to your friends? “Hey Bill How are you today? How did that project go?” Before putting this system to use let’s learn about the people you will meet.

Who Are All These People?

Most Valuable Player

Who is the most prominent personality in the room with you?

Who is the most important person?

Who is deserving of the most attention and dedicated mental Framing?

In any conversation, the MVP is the person with whom you are interacting. The most crucial thing in your life at any moment, while you are communicating, is the other person interacting with you. You, Reader, are the most important person in this book. While writing I have the image of you. There is no one and nothing more important than the individual with whom you are communicating. Keep this in mind as you interact with people, as distractions try to creep into your thoughts and senses. Your phone will be there later; you can get food later; if you left the stove on, it could stay on for a few more minutes. Do not let your Mental State or Frame be distracted, nor your attention from the person with whom you are interacting. Your body and feet continue to point at the other person throughout the interaction.

Expectations

“Remove your expectations from interactions.” People are used to two types of conversations: expectation based and time fillers — weather until the elevator opens. People are not used to holding enjoyable conversations with no debt attached. People are very unused to someone walking up to them, starting a conversation, and becoming happier as they talk to that person. Your goal is to become the type of person who walks up to another person and engages with them to get to know them and improve their mood. That is a purpose. It is not a bill they owe you. If you like that person, you can quickly become friends or closer acquaintances. There is a drastic difference between knowing the result of a conversation and having an expectation from a conversation. If you know someone is a client, you will help them. If you want someone to be a client you will sell them. The same rule applies to religion, politics, MLM’s, dating, and on and on. You will read other people’s intentions; others will read yours. After your third positive interaction with an individual, they should know what you do and who you are. When properly following the no expectations rule, you will get to know other people, and the conversation will lead to both of you agreeing or disagreeing on exchanging value. For customer service and sales work

your interaction will just be assisting your customer. Plenty of personal friends are made from sales conversations without expectation or a sale. You should enter every introduction and conversation with absolutely no expectation. You intend to communicate with that person, which means a back and forth exchange of information. Your goal is to get to know them and find out if they are a person similar to you so you can decide if you want to be their friend or interact with them again in the future. Speaking of expectations, you might expect the people around you to change.

Unmeet People

As you meet new people and gain new friends and acquaintances, you will start to build connections with people who are a positive influence on you. As you do, you may find that your core group of family and friends changes. Many times you will find that certain individuals in your life negatively influence you; unmeet them. Unmeet is not to say to forget you have ever known them or “ghost” them. Unmeet only means to reduce your intentional interactions with them. If your framing and genuine happiness do not rub off on them via transference, you can gradually reduce your time spent with them and effectively unmeet them. You don’t announce it. You just stop being the person who keeps starting the interaction. People with a constant negative Mental State can overpower an intentional positive Mental State and drag you down in life. That is the other side of The 5 Friends in Chapter 8. You unmeet by giving people less time. You turn a stranger into a friend by giving the right people more time, on a clock the brain actually keeps.

Timelines

There is a simple set of timelines the human brain seems to prefer to enhance the strength of the impression you have on someone. Everyone will be different in this regard, so these are simple guiding principles for those without an intuitive guide to use. The goal of sharing these timelines is simply to help you move along an acquaintance or friendship timeline in a more predictable and faster way than what most people seem to believe. Once again this applies to both personal and professional relationships.

The timing of the structured introduction: 0 Seconds Make eye contact then smile

< 5 seconds Decide the ending Mental State of the other person.

Apply that Mental State to yourself.

Frame the other individual into that State.

Picture or imagine the interaction happening.

Up to 5 seconds Point your body and feet toward the individual, mirror, slightly raise your eyebrows, and CLIFFORD.

The five-second rule is alive and well in our brains. You have five seconds in which to mentally prepare to interact with someone. Those mental preparations include framing and imagining the interaction. If you don't take action within five seconds, your brain will choose a fight, flight, or freeze response. In the case of meeting people, it will choose to flee. If your brain chooses to freeze you just stand or sit there smiling at someone, don't do that. It's somewhere between strange and creepy. One-on-one we teach 3 seconds to leave a small buffer. The goal is instant action. See someone, speak to someone.

The oddly accurate general interaction timeline to help you move from stranger to friend or client faster.

A positive interaction is where most of the emotions expressed by both parties are happiness or positive emotions, and the interaction ends on a positive emotion. One negative interaction costs two positive interactions based on the rule of people running from sadness with twice the vigor they run towards joy.

Zero Interactions, not acquainted, a stranger. A person you have not met and don't have the means to contact regularly. Someone who wouldn't help you move or buy anything from you.

One neutral interaction, weakly acquainted, a person you've met. A person you have met and don't have the means to contact regularly. Generally, this just means you met someone in passing, and either did not have enough similarities to continue the conversation or did not have enough time to find the similarities. In passing, you would say hello and ask CLIFFORD follow-up questions. Someone who wouldn't help you move or buy anything from you.

One positive interaction, acquainted, an acquaintance. A person you have met and for whom you may have the means to contact regularly. Generally, this is a person you set up a follow-up interaction with. In passing, you would say hello and ask CLIFFORD follow-up questions. In private, you would plan followup interactions, someone who probably wouldn't help you move or buy something from you.

Fourteen days: After having one positive interaction with someone, your next positive in-person interaction should be no more than fourteen days after your first interaction. The emotional impact of an interaction fades over the course of three weeks and begins to decline exponentially after 14 days. Most people will forget you and your conversation within a fortnight. At fifteen days your interactions reset back to zero for this timeline.

Three hours of positive individual interaction after one or two meetings: almost a friend, an acquaintance. A person you have met and for whom you have the means to contact regularly. Generally this happens between the first and second interaction. In passing, you would plan a follow-up interaction and ask CLIFFORD follow-up questions. In private, you would plan follow-up interactions, someone who might help you move or buy something from you. Twenty-eight days: the next rung. You should have three positive interactions totaling nine hours (personal) or two hours (professional) of one-on-one time within the first twenty-eight days. That is three meetings, about three hours each if it is personal. There is a balance somewhere within this range. One-on-ones, meetings between a superior and subordinate, are 30 minutes once a week, so you should be spending more dedicated time than this with new acquaintances or love interests.

Three positive interactions, close acquaintance, a friend. A person you have met and with whom you have semi-regularly contact, someone who probably would help you move or buy something from you.

Seven to Nine hours of positive interactions, close friend, a friend. A person you have met and for whom you have semi-regular contact, someone who will help you move and buy something from you.

Fourteen to twenty-one positive interactions in under 90 days, core friend, a close or core friend. A person you have met and interacted with for several cumulative hours and continue to interact with regularly. A person with whom you would confide traumas or deep desires, someone who you would expect to help you move and buy something from you.

Again these timelines are simply meant for those without an intuitive guide or read on their levels of acquaintance or friendship.

Meet People

Once you have read this far you are ready to start meeting more people. Meeting people will require some minor changes in your habits. If you usually order things online, you should, at a bare minimum, begin going to local stores to look for those things before ordering. The more expensive route, of course, is to buy those things in stores. Your means and financial preferences will determine which path you take. The important step is to begin getting out there where the people are.

Start building your Rolodex; you'll find at least one exciting outcome as you do this. Whenever you need something -- a job, a mechanic, a plumber, an accountant, an executive coach, a consultant, someone to go skydiving with -- you will only have to reach out to your new contacts and ask. Each person you meet expands your connections exponentially.

You may have learned from Kevin Bacon that everyone connects to everyone else through no more than six people. The concept is called six degrees of separation, and it oddly has very little to do with Kevin Bacon. If you know six new people and need to find someone who does something, you are now six times more likely to find or know someone who does that thing. The concept was first proposed by the Hungarian author Karinthy in 1929 and later studied by Stanley Milgram and others. Six degrees is a ballpark, not a defined rule.

Before you leave to meet people, you can bring some people to you.

Bring more people in In addition to getting out more to meet more people, you should begin doing small things to bring people to you. You can join Facebook groups or other online chat forums. You may find running through the CLIFFORD structured introduction on an online platform such as Facebook can yield many new contacts. "Hey everyone, I'm Reader, I'm a professional underwater basket weaver from Missoula Montana. Where is everyone else from?" Include the answers to the From, Family, Occupation, Recreation, and Dreams portion of the introduction. For each response, you would give the related response and follow up with the next question. If you make it through the first few questions of F.F.O.R.D., you would close the conversation with: "Hey, Name, you sound very interesting. Can we continue this chat via direct message." or whatever the equivalent platform etiquette is. The next way to start getting people to come to you is to list things for sale online. Marketplace and the like allow you to post items at no cost and take messages or calls. Once people start reaching out, you can start using a conversational version of the structured introduction. The next three are optional volume, not the next habit after going to the store. You can rent out a room, a shed, your yard, or your boat. There are tons of different startup companies and existing

companies that link people who need something with people who have those things. You live somewhere; you have either physical items or skills which you can rent to other people. That process will generally result in some form of direct contact. In your spare time on your own time, you can drive for a service such as Uber or Lyft. Driving puts you into constant situations of being near another human with time to spare. Run through CLIFFORD the moment someone gets comfortable in your car. See how many people you can meet. You can start a small business or what's often referred to as a side hustle. As you'll learn later, this could be a doubly effective way to meet more people. Make or purchase things that can be sold online, at home, and at local events.

Nonvisual Communications Voice and Text

In Chapter 5 you learned about Dr. Mehrabian's research into the effect of tone and facial expressions on communication. Follow-up research showed the impact of nonverbal communication is stronger when observed in person than in photographs, videos, or recordings. Järveläinen, Schürmann, Avikainen, and Hari found stronger reactivity in the human primary motor cortex when people watched a live motor act than when they watched the same act on video. That means less of your meaning gets through on a phone or a screen. Smiling and Mental States matter more when the other person is not physically in front of you, because you have to amplify what is left. This is one of the worst mistakes job seekers make in phone interviews. You should be dressed better than you would be in person and stand, not sit, so you display more nonverbal movement while on the call. In person you use genuine emotions and Framing so your body language matches your intentions. When they cannot see you, the visual part of the message has to travel through tone and words. The easiest way to convey the same meaning is to use the same actions — then drop the parts the channel cannot carry. The framing method: Decide the ending Mental State of the other person.

Apply that Mental State to yourself.

Frame the other individual into that State.

Picture or imagine the interaction happening.

Smile, stand up, slightly raise your eyebrows, and CLIFFORD. You can't make eye contact over the phone or while writing. Pointing your body and feet at the phone is a little strange. You won't be able to mirror unless they start the conversation. So you keep state, frame, picture, smile, stand, brows, CLIFFORD. With phone interactions you can ring your SmileBell when you pick up or dial. Smile, stand, then talk.

Incoming call from someone you don't know: "This is Reader; how can I help you?" Incoming call from someone you know: "Hey Name, How are you doing on this wonderful Tuesday?"

Outgoing call to someone you don't know: The first line is whatever they say — "Can I have

your name/account number” or “It’s a great day at xyz widgets how can I help you.” Then you work. Sprinkle CLIFFORD through the conversation. Don’t make the call about the questions. Practice on customer service lines for products you already use. Ask something mundane and throw in CLIFFORD. By the end you should know something about the representative.

Written Communications

Written communications are better when you are smiling and have correctly framed the conversation. You are being smiled at right now. Those laughing and smiling emojis should be real when you are having a brief text-based chat. Smile and write or type. You frame conversations even when they are in writing.

The structured introduction is a guide for all communications. Not just meeting new people. Not just in person. Now it’s time for you to meet people.

Get Out and Meet People

“It’s very people-y outside.” There are people all over, you will have to get out and meet them. Then have follow-up interactions with those people. With each interaction, your communication skills will naturally improve. Getting out more means you replace the habits of staying in with going out and meeting people. You are not smashing through a wall. You are replacing one errand. Start meeting people who will respond to you. As you grow in your abilities, you will find it easier to have conversations with random people. The first steps in meeting more people are to take things you may currently do and vary how you do them. You consume things, purchase things, when you do, either shop in person or browse in person. Spend more time at physical stores where people shop. You will start small conversations with other customers and staff at these stores. You have to eat, this requires either grocery stores or restaurants. Instead of ordering online, for delivery, or even take out or drive through begin dining in. Find a few places you like and frequent them. You have hobbies, interests, or just events around your area, places where people gather. Find out where and when these events happen and lookup interest-based events or shows in your area. Begin running through the introduction steps with people while you are out. Ask about other events or places to go. As you have conversations with people, ask them what different events are happening in the local area and beyond. Some of them will invite you to attend other similar events. Some examples of places and ways to meet people. The local convenience store or pharmacy, the grocery store, local bars and restaurants, religious gatherings, anywhere you go where other people also go. Some examples of places to find meetings -- facebook events, meetup.com, professional group or association meetings, user groups, lifestyle groups, community events, movies at the park, museum events, the list is nearly endless. Some more niche settings where you meet people and practice interacting -- dating apps and singles events, educational or college courses at any age, job interviews and job fairs, part or full time sales or customer service jobs, Toastmasters International, open houses, investor meetings, auctions, the list is nearly endless.

Meet the Extroverts and Hosts

When you are out, start looking for the most prominent personality amongst groups. You want to meet the hosts, the extroverts, and those who know everyone. You are not being asked to host the event. Stand near the people who already are. The closer you stand to the registration table, the greeter, or the person with the unofficial “designated extrovert” job,

the faster your comfort and skill move. Communications skill improves all aspects of human life. That is real-life advice: get next to the person whose job is already to talk. If you go to a bar or restaurant, meet the servers, the managers, and the regulars. Always have a pleasant conversation with servers and bartenders and others who have regular contact with multiple people. They will accelerate your access to people exponentially and can introduce you to many others. In professional networking settings, this is the event organizer or host. Those in the service industry meet all types of people and have a requirement to interact. Running through the entire CLIFFORD structured introduction is time-consuming and generally not a good idea. For this instance, in general, you would skip to CLID or CLIRD, asking about professional or educational aspirations and recreational activities. What if “x.” “What if they don’t want to talk to me?” “What if I introduce myself to someone, and they are boring?” “What if I just like ‘people-watching’?” “What if ‘X’?”

What if a meteor crashes through the ceiling and lands on your brain? What if everyone likes you? What if you take the time to interact genuinely and without expectation, with everyone you meet and just one of those individuals feels happiness for the first time in a long time. What if it spreads throughout their life? The fear will show up. You will still be fine. “What if they don’t want to talk to me?” There are over eight billion humans on this planet. Some of them don’t have time to talk to you. Some of them don’t want to talk to you right now. Some of them don’t want to talk to you at all. Some of them have a bias “What if I introduce myself to someone, and they are boring?”

A “boring” person is not talking about something for which they have a passion or a strong feeling. Find out what they are passionate about, they will open up and keep talking.

“What if I just like ‘people-watching’?”

People-watching is a fantastic way to meet new people. Preferably while out with one or more friends, observe those around you, make a story about what they are doing. Are they on a date? Is it a first date? Are they family? Business meeting? You and those you are with make a story about them. Then walk up and tell them you and your friends were wondering who was right.

While out at a local brewery for a friend’s birthday. After meeting the greeter, which resulted in being owed a drink, the four of us sat on a couch in a more secluded section of the building. It was dimly lit in this area, which was adjoined by a bar and a dining area. Roughly half of the bar was visible through an opening in a decorative divider placed to give the room some privacy.

Through that opening, I was able to see a person facing towards another bar stool. During conversations amongst our group, I kept observing the person sitting at the bar, making large gestures and having thunderous body talk, big animated movements out of the corner of my eye. This observation left me laughing a lot as this person was having an enthusiastic conversation with themselves!

Later I excused myself to use the restroom and stopped by to share my observation: compliment, introduction, story. It turns out there was another person present and they were on a date. After telling the story from my view of this crazy person having an overly animated conversation with no one, we all laughed enough for the greeter to ask what was going on.

The retelling of the entire story was now to the audience of the couple, the greeter and the bartender. Everyone enjoyed hearing about this and new friends were made.

Mastering the Skill

Malcolm Gladwell proposed that it takes 10,000 hours of practice to achieve mastery. Treat that as a story, not a requirement. You are not clocking an eight-hour communications shift for five years. You practice communication any time you are not alone — even when you are avoiding, even when the conversation only happens in your head. Those reps exist. They just don't move you as fast as a live one. If you have a thousand positive interactions in a year, less than three a day, you will be more than comfortable using the methods in this book. Do that and you will be a strong communicator — the kind of person who can sell, speak, and write for other people without the work showing. If you only hit a few live interactions a week, you will still progress at an amazing rate. Familiarity is the basis of knowledge, knowledge is the basis of effective action, effective action is the basis for positive results, and repeated positive results are the basis for confidence. To become familiar with the concepts and methods herein on a shorter timeline, you can increase your effective interactions. Practice in real life. Dedicate time each day to go to places and meet people. Dedicate time each week to attend events and meet people.

Witness real-life examples. Watch for examples of framing or reframing. Have an extrovert take you out on an introduction spree to meet a bunch of people.

Witness fictional examples. Watch who the room orbits, who smiles first, who holds the frame.

Practice with friends or family. Roleplay interactions and practice framing.

Replay interactions mentally and reexperience interactions mentally.

The Physical Not the Psychological

Before you move from people you select to groups, clear this up. Group interactions are multiple personal interactions with one difference: the room will contain people you might not have chosen.

Tribe Mentality

People like others who are similar to themselves. The opposite is also true. People dislike others who are dissimilar. Judgment is something our brains do to protect us. For generations, people who are different from us have fought for our resources. Operant conditioning kept the shortcut: fear the dissimilar. Prejudice is that shortcut. Humans run from fear with twice the effort they run towards happiness. In all of us some bias exists toward appearance, opinions, or beliefs.

Get out of your cave

Nothing is more comfortable than a room of people who share your opinions and always agree with you. That is the cave. Groups are not the cave. Getting along in groups — and leading people — requires you to get along with humans. They come in a variety of styles.

The reason for X-Phobia and X-Ism

Judgment becomes part of your emotional state. That state hits the other person. If you know you have a bias, get more aware of it so you can set a frame that bypasses it.

You cannot hide a bias. You can overcome it.

Bias toward: you freeze because they are a celebrity, better looking, a politician, “above you.”

Bias against: race, color, religion, sex (including sexual orientation or assignment), national origin, disability, or age. Same issue. It shows in the body. Practice the state on the people who make your brain uncomfortable. You will talk to a lot of people from diverse backgrounds with diverse opinions. Do not hand them the fear because your brain is scared. Everyone can teach you something, so be the dumbest person in the room. When your brain is speaking to someone else's brain it's two mushy balls of white and gray matter. Each bit of mush has different and similar life experiences and talents. Yours can learn from theirs. Deprogramming your biases is the key to interacting with and leading people. You are not there to be the most comfortable animal in the cave. You are there to learn.

PART IV

Groups

Meeting Groups of People

Let's review, this should come as no surprise to you, when interacting with individuals in a group or with a group of people you use the structured introduction. What follows is a series of steps for interacting with groups, described briefly to give you a general guide, not detailed instructions, on how to meet thousands of people.

Make eye contact, then smile.

Decide the ending Mental State of the other people or person.

Apply that Mental State to yourself.

Frame the other individual or group of individuals into that State.

Picture or imagine the interaction happening.

Point your body and feet toward the individual or group, mirror, slightly raise your eyebrows, and CLIFFORD.

Continue to Attend Events

If you haven't been attending events, go back to Chapter 12. Dozens, if not hundreds, of events occur each month in most cities. Many are niche — comic cons, user groups, professional association meetings. There will be political events, protests, professional networking events, improv comedy shows. Whatever your interest, there are events for you. Use the same places already listed in Chapter 12.

Find a few groups who meet regularly

People like people who are similar to themselves. Find A group of people who meet regularly about a shared interest. Weekly, monthly, or semi-monthly so you can have regular contact with the group.

Become a regular

After attending a recurring meeting a few times, you should have a mixture of people you already know and people you don't know. Remember, you may have forgotten some people's names, especially if you haven't followed up with them in between meetings. When you see

someone who knows your name and you don't remember their name, you ask, "Oh, it's so nice to see you again, and I cannot for the life of me remember your name; I'm so sorry."

Introduce yourself and try to start running through CLIFFORD with even more people. For people you've already met and spoken to, you will ask them about anything that's happened since the last time you saw them or how the important people in their life are doing by name. "Hey, Name the architect. It's great to see you again; I like that shirt on you; how is <your project, your significant other, anything from CLIFFORD>?" Getting an update might be your entire conversation with that person, and that's fine. You have more people to meet and can run through conversations with more people.

By now, you should notice that you are still interacting with individuals. Groups are just a bunch of individuals. When you continue interacting with individuals in a group, it inevitably leads to interacting directly with the entire group.

Become the Greeter

Once you find a regularly occurring meeting, show up a bit early. Find the person handing out name tags or running the meeting if that person is the one at the door greeting people. Run through CLIFFORD and get to know them. If they have name tags, that's great; if not, take out yours and suggest using them. Yes, it's a good idea to always bring nametags with you to meetings. Name tags are fantastic. The best way to get to know the most people is to stand at the entrance to the event to greet every person who comes in. If you keep standing there, you become the greeter whether anyone voted or not. Build a descriptive name for each guest as they enter. For each person who walks through the door, you compliment them or make an observation, introduce yourself, then ask them a question or make a comment. Some things to ask, how long they have been in the group, how they know about the group, or precisely what about the group's purpose they find the most interesting. You will build a more descriptive name for them, Jordan, with the blue pants, Avery with the glasses. Did you forget their name? Forgetting a name happens. "Hey, I'm sorry I just met a ton of people and completely forgot your name." If you happen to forget their name again later during the event, you ask again! "Ok, I feel terrible, what was your name again?" The greeter is a significant role to have as you will network with everyone and have exposure to the same people over multiple occasions. Greeter, usher, collecting entry fees, there are many different versions of this role. As the greeter, regardless of whether it is official or not, when someone walks in you will need to know if they are new to the group. "Is this your first time here?" If they are new, do they know anyone in the group? How they found out about the group. "Are you meeting up with someone here or did you just find the group online?" If they are a regular or older member who you just haven't met, they will go in and find their spot or

usual routine. If they are new, you have the opportunity to provide them with some details about the group and introduce them to another extrovert or a host. As described in the next section, you can also move them around the group and introduce them to more people.

Provide Social Lubrication

Like pouring oil on the group? Yes.

In any group setting, people will naturally form into smaller subgroups, referred to as cliques. These subgroups are the result of the ineffectiveness of holding conversations in groups larger than, roughly, seven individuals. The problem with this is new people in the group and introverts generally see these subgroups as surrounded by a wall. When someone walks into a meeting and sees a group of people talking, they believe it's a close-knit group of like-minded people having a private group conversation. This is generally false, although over time, it becomes more true if groups lack extroverts or exercises to get people talking and moving.

As the greeter, you are the first point of contact for a person entering the meeting. After you greet someone new to the group you should either introduce them to a designated extrovert or facilitator or invite them directly into a subgroup and make introductions. Walk them in and run two beats out loud: their name, one hook from CLIFFORD (where they're from, what they do, first time here), then step back. If you stay, they talk to you instead of the subgroup.

Being the greeter also gives you the ability to invite people to different groups than they would normally go into themselves. As you get to know the regular attendees better, you can move people between groups to keep rotating conversations. Later, after all or most attendees have arrived or arriving traffic slows, you can move from subgroup to subgroup in order to maximize the number of individuals you meet.

If a subgroup is stuck, give them a non-controversial controversial: which way should the toilet paper hang off the roll, front or back? Pineapple on pizza? Something to play with that isn't status or politics.

You can also rotate the room on purpose. Swap tables. Everyone take one step clockwise. Change who is standing next to whom. That is the institutional version of moving people.

At an appropriate venue, when it was appropriate, I have physically carried people between subgroups to stir things up. Ridiculous on purpose. The action itself got the group talking and more lively. That is not homework. It is proof that stirring the pot is the lubrication.

Introduce two people to each other, then walk away. Oil the stuck groups. Don't break a group that is already hot. You are not the entertainment. You are traffic. Each individual interacting with more individuals will make group meetings more exciting and cause people to want to invite more of their friends. This strengthens the group and adds more contacts for you to meet, interact with, and have in your Rolodex.

If you notice a small group isn't talking, the first thing to do is to ensure you are not looking at a group of introverts or ambiverts. They will often sit down when that's an option. For this group, a simple "Hey, how is everyone doing?" will suffice. Introverts should be framed as calm and relaxed, not as overly happy or interactive.

Adopt The Introverts

Introverts in a meeting often look like they hit a wall. They sit when sitting is an option. They are not broken, and they are not waiting for you to turn them into the designated extrovert. Frame them calm and relaxed, not overly happy. Don't drop them into the loudest subgroup. Walk them to one specific person, run two beats (name, one hook), then leave. "This is Avery. Avery, this is Jordan — first time here, also in the same line of work." Then you go. If they want a slower ramp than the door, volunteer to take them on a short introduction pass: two or three people, then you stop. That is the same move as having an extrovert take you on an introduction spree. You are the extrovert for one lap. You are not their manager. If they want out of a group outing, let them out.

Give them the 4%. They will talk when the subject is theirs. They may take a moment before they answer. That pause is not rejection.

You adopt an introvert by making the room survivable. A door that isn't a wall, one named person, and a way to leave.

Never Shy Away From Being The Leader

Your repeated attendance and chosen part as the greeter, social lubricator, and or designated extrovert will eventually put you in front of the room. This could come in the form of running the meeting's opening remarks or presenting something to the group. It could also come in the form of the regular host being unavailable and asking you to fill in.

You do not have to hunt the gavel. When the room hands you the mic, take it. People will come to you with questions about the group and upcoming meetings. That increases your standing and gets you in front of the entire group at once.

Become A Host

Creating your own meetings or leading an existing meeting is the next step. You already have experience attending and filling in. This step is organizing, or hiring an organizer, and putting a date on the calendar.

You can host a poker night at the house, have a seasonal recreation group, set up a DnD game, take a group of people to get skydive certified and attend events. Think of something you like or something related to your profession, find a venue, invite people to meet regularly.

Become a Vendor or set up a booth

Another way to increase your exposure to other people in line with the above is to get a vendor booth at local recreational or professional events. As a vendor, you will have access to the groups and their attendees. Sell something, make something or just get a vendor booth that says, “introduce yourself!” Bring a friend so you can roam the event and do name practice. Introduce yourself to everyone you can. This is optional volume, not the next homework after greeting. A booth, a table, or — same idea, different room — a driving shift for a ride service. People come to you. You run the stack.

Public Speaking

Public speaking is a loaded phrase. It is still the same stack: state, frame, smile, then talk. You can stop at greeter or vendor and have used this book. If you want the mic, look for one. You should have had opportunities to speak to groups by now; if not, you will need to seek out opportunities to do so. When running your group for whatever reason, you can simply have some portion that involves a presentation or speech. Presentations can be done by yourself each time or rotated around between members or even invite experts or specialists to present. Rotating the presenter means you are not the speech every week. The important thing is that you begin looking for places to speak to groups. The three key things you can do to improve your public speaking and perhaps your overall communication skills are speaking in public, joining a Toastmasters International group, and taking improv comedy classes.

Get Nominated, Run for office, Get Elected

You don't need to run for president. If you want to, feel free. Many non-profits and professional groups have elected boards. Every locality has council seats and similar positions. You may not have to campaign first. If you have been the greeter, the lubricator, the person who remembers names and moves people around, the room already saw the work. People nominate what they have already watched. That is how it happened for me. They saw what I was doing in the group and put my name in. If the name goes in, take it the same way you took the mic. Same stack. You are still talking to one person at a time, even when the group is voting.

This is the last optional rung. You can stop at regular, greeter, or vendor and have finished the book. Office is just the same habit with a title on it.

Keep Meeting People

Take Action

If you read this far without practicing the SmileBell exercises or the CLIFFORD structured introduction, start now. Knowing the content can help. Only action makes the change last. The methods in this book were learned, tested, failed, repeated, then taught until they were one stack. They were cut down to what a person with social anxiety or a professional salesperson actually needs. Each chapter and section is designed to build on the last and to build up your communication skills and confidence.

Feedback Loop

To succeed, especially at combating social anxiety and in the same sense to improve your communication skills, you will create a confidence feedback loop. Feeling good about what you are doing while succeeding creates confidence. When you feel or imitate confidence and an interaction goes well, you will gain more confidence. With each iteration, your confidence will grow stronger. Fear is the primary reason people don't interact as genuinely and openly as they could. Specifically, fear of failure or rejection, which causes you to lose self confidence. "We can all choose to expand our confidence. But we will get there only if we stop trying to be perfect and start being prepared to fail." ~The Confidence Code by Katty Kay and Claire Shipman You were trained young that failure is bad, negative, or punishable. Remember school? Success is good, failure is bad. That becomes fear of failure. Humans will run away from fear with twice as much effort as they will run towards a reward. Your brain has assessed the risk of failing at human interaction, found examples of failures, and caused you to run away twice as hard as the rewards you get from talking to people. You started this book by smiling and showing genuine happiness. That is the simplest and smallest step to beginning to break the loop that tells your brain to avoid extended human interactions.

Truth

People like honest people who are similar to themselves. A lot of people are untruthful to some extent. You see this in many aspects of life. People will lie or exaggerate in job interviews. The dating world is full of people who seemed nice for the first few months. There is no reason for you to be dishonest. You don't owe a stranger your whole file. You owe them a real face. You can decline a topic and still be honest. The vast majority of reasons for

dishonesty in the first place only exist due to people's lack of confidence and communication skills. Once you complete the activities you've read and met hundreds of people, you will find that truth outweighs dishonesty in every facet of human interactions.

More Action

Humans love comfort. People will stick with what's comfortable and familiar for a very long time. Whatever you dream or desire, put some portion of your time and mental capacity toward it. Become confident and you feel rewarded for attempts, not for staying comfortable without them.

Examples Used

Each and every story of an interaction and example conversation used is real. Most names were changed or removed for privacy. Some details were compressed. The events happened. Make eye contact. Smile. Go meet someone.